

REPUBLIQUE DU CAMEROUN

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ELECTIONS CAMEROON
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Direction Générale des Elections



REPUBLIC OF CAMEROON

Peace - Work - Fatherland

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ELECTIONS CAMEROON
(ELECAM)

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Directorate General of Elections

Elections Cameroon

ELECAM

GENERAL REPORT ON CONDUCT OF THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS

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ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

A- ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS USED BY POLITICAL PARTIES

CDU:	Cameroon Democratic Union
CNSF:	Cameroon National Salvation Front
CPDM:	Cameroon People's Democratic Movement
CPNR:	Cameroon Party for National Reconciliation
FDC:	Front des Démocrates Camerounais
MDR:	Mouvement pour la Défense de la République
NADP:	National Alliance for Democracy and Progress
NUDP:	National Union for Democracy and Progress
SDF:	Social Democratic Front
UMS:	Union des Mouvements Socialistes

B- ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS USED BY OTHER INSTITUTIONS

CEB:	Chairperson of the Electoral Board
DGE:	Directorate General of Elections
DGSN:	General Delegation for National Security
EB:	Electoral Board
ELECAM:	Elections Cameroon
ER:	Election Report
LPC:	Local Polling Commission
MEB:	Members of the Electoral Board
MINDDEVEL:	Ministry of Decentralisation and Local Development
MINAT:	Ministry of Territorial Administration
MINCOM:	Ministry of Communication
MINREX:	Ministry of External Relations
NCFCV:	National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes

ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

PS:	Polling station
RSC:	Regional Supervisory Commission
SED:	Secretariat of State of Defence

FOREWORD

This report, prepared as part of the duties entrusted to the Director General of Elections under Section 26 (5) of the Electoral Code, relates the conduct of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators in a chronological order. The report provides an exhaustive account of activities carried out by ELECAM and other stakeholders of the electoral process.

Part I of this report is a narration, while Part II comprises a compilation of annexes that constitute an important and additional source for information.

The intent of this report is to provide readers with ample objective facts they can use to appraise efforts made by stakeholders to ensure the election of the third batch of 70 senators representing the regional and local authorities that make up the Senate.

I hope all readers of this report find it satisfactory.

**Dr ESSOUSSE Erik,
DIRECTOR GENERAL OF ELECTIONS,**

GENERAL INTRODUCTION

The election of Senators on 12 March 2023 was the third of its kind in the political and institutional history of Cameroon. This election followed those held on 14 April 2013 and 25 March 2018, which correspond to the first and second term of office, respectively, of the Upper House of Parliament.

Moreover, it must be observed that the Senate represents regional and local authorities and that renewal of this Upper House conforms to the Constitution, and espouses the vision of effectively implementing the decentralisation process that constitutes the nature per se of the Cameroonian Nation. Moreover, it must be observed that the publication of Decree No 2023/023 of 13 January 2023 convening the electoral college for the election of senators against a backdrop marked by State resolve to consolidate democratic advances in Cameroon and to decisively carry on the development of regional and local authorities through the decentralisation process.

From a socio-political standpoint, and contrary to the previous term of office whose senators were elected by an electoral college composed only of municipal councillors, the mandate of Senators was to be renewed, for the very first time, by a complete electoral college made up of the municipal councillors

and regional councillors elected respectively on 9 February 2020, 6 December 2020 and 4 April 2021 elected on 2020.

At security level, even with threats of insecurity looming on an effective holding of polls in the North-West and South-West Regions, the election took place in a context marked by general appeasement. The main challenge in these regions was in deploying and safeguarding election material and documents right up to polling stations, ensuring security for senatorial electors as well as other stakeholders of the electoral process concerned. This major challenge was met thanks to measures taken by administrative authorities and assistance from forces of defence and security.

As concerns the organisational aspect, the 12 March 2023 election of Senators held in a context marked by high expectations, where election observers and the main actors as well as beneficiaries in the form of political parties proved to be more conversant with various facets of the material organisation of elections, ranging from update of voters' register, through election logistics, to functioning of local polling commissions or handling of election documents.

Mindful of the importance of these stakes, Elections Cameroon (ELECAM) had, once again, to live

up to the challenge of a hitch-free organisation, by deploying all its resources and working together with all stakeholders of the electoral process, with a view to meet the challenge of having ensured a successful organisation of the polls that will allow for a renewal of one of the most important and sensitive institutions on the institutional landscape of Cameroon.

This report, prepared as part of the duties entrusted to the Director General of Elections under Section 26 (5) of the Electoral Code, sums up the organisation and conduct of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators in a chronological and logical order. The report outlines activities carried out by Elections Cameroon as well as institutions and stakeholders vested with a key role in conduct of the electoral process.

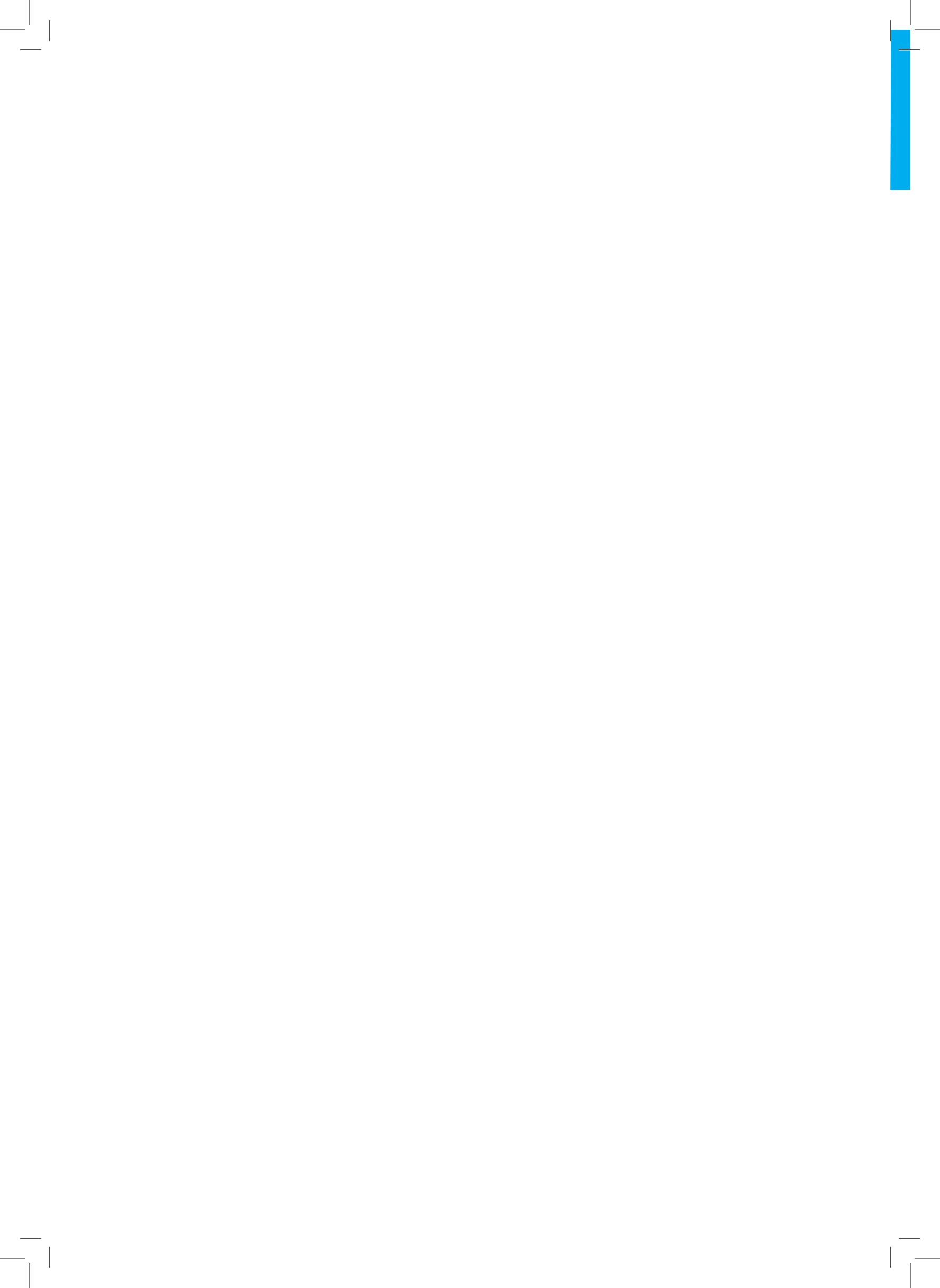
Comprising 6 (six) parts, Part I of this report describes the legal and institutional framework. Part II focuses on preparations for the election. Part III renders account on conduct of the election. Part IV recalls the post-election litigation and proclamation of the election results. Part V deals with funding of the election. Part VI mentions some difficulties encountered and formulates recommendations. The final part of this report includes annexed documents (texts, tables, diagrams and bar charts) whose inclusion in the body of this report would have

made for a more tedious reading. This part, nevertheless, constitutes a priceless source of information in the event where any reader finds it necessary to seek for additional information.

PART I: LEGAL AND INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK

The 12 March 2023 election of Senators is governed by texts that have as goal an organisation capable of guaranteeing the specific rights of all stakeholders. Thus, it is on the basis of these texts that, on voting day, municipal councillors and regional councillors had the opportunity to choose, in absolute free-

dom of conscience and secrecy, the representatives of regional and local authorities within the Senate. The chapter below describes the legal and institutional framework applicable to this election.



CHAPTER I: LEGAL AND INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK

The credibility of any electoral process depends, to a large extent, on the legal instruments that govern it and on the institutions that regulate it. In terms of definition, the legal and institutional framework of this process is the set of rules that governs and stakeholders that play a role in the electoral process.

Going beyond the general principles of law and best practices, this chapter recalls the constitutional and legal provisions that govern the election of Senators.

The chapter comprises 2 (two) sections, namely the legal or normative framework and the institutional framework.

SECTION I: LEGAL OR NORMATIVE FRAMEWORK

The Constitution of 18 January 1996, amended on 14 April 2008 remains, as fundamental law, the basic text that specifies and sets the legal framework applicable to election matters in Cameroon. **Law No 2012/001 of 19 April 2012** relating to the Electoral Code and its subsequent amendments further clarifies provisions specific to the election of Senators, set in motion by the decree of the President of the Republic convening the electoral college for the election of Senators, which provides specifications on the date for the election as well as opening and closing time for polls.

In actual fact, and pursuant to the Constitution, State authorities derive their power from the people

through election by direct or indirect universal suffrage. Political parties are instruments essential to promoting and vibrancy of democracy in the country. As a result, they take part in the expression of suffrage. The Electoral Code, for its part, clearly defines provisions that govern the election of Senators referred to under **Part VIII**, notably **Sections 214 to 242**. This mostly concerns the system of election, eligibility conditions, electoral registers and voter cards

SECTION II: INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK

Elections Cameroon is the main actor as concerns the material organisation and supervision of the electoral process in Cameroon. In view of carrying out this task, this institution relies on support from other stakeholders like the Ministry of Territorial Administration, Judiciary, the National Communication Council, joint electoral commissions and the Constitutional Council. The participation of all these stakeholders reflects the inclusive and transparent nature of the electoral process.

Each of the abovementioned institutions play their distinctive roles as follows:

- 1- Political Parties:** endorse and submit lists of candidates for the election of Senators.
- 2- Ministry of Territorial Administration:** accredits national and international election observers. It draws up the code of best practices for observers

in collaboration with Elections Cameroon. It ensures security coordination for the electoral process. It serves as Government agent at the level of Elections Cameroon.

3- Judiciary: presides over regional supervisory commissions and participates as member in the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes.

4- Administrative Authorities: ensure observance of public order and regulation by political parties, candidates, electors and users, before, during and after the polls.

5- Forces of defence and security: ensure security before, during and after the election.

6- National Communication Council: ensures observance of ethics and professional conduct by the media and ensures regulation of their activities in all phases of the electoral process.

7- Local polling commissions: coordinate voting operations, carry out vote counting and draw up election return reports in every polling station.

8- Regional supervisory commissions: centralise, compile and verify vote counts on the basis of election return reports and relevant annexed documents forwarded by local polling commissions.

9- National Commission for the Final Counting Votes: carries

out final counting of votes on the basis of election reports and relevant annexed documents forwarded by regional supervisory commissions.

10- Constitutional Council: hears pre- and post-election petitions relating to the election of Senators, ensures regularity in the entire process and proclaims the election results.

In conformity with the corresponding constitutional provisions, laws and regulations that govern each aspect of the organisation of elections, all the stakeholders listed above played a role in organising the 12 March 2023 election of Senators starting from preparatory operations.

PART II: PREPARATIONS FOR THE POLLS

This part of the report relates activities carried out prior to the polls. Such activities concern the voter's register, election material and documents, communication, inclusion of minority and socially-vulnerable groups, management of candidacy files, litigation related to list of candi-

dates, capacity-building of election agents, management of the election campaign, control and supervision by the Electoral Board, securing the electoral process and coordination of election observer actions.

CHAPTER I: UPDATING THE REGISTER OF VOTERS

From time immemorial, be it an election or non-election year, having a credible register of voters is a prerequisite essential to the organisation and success of any electoral process. This important aspect of the election constitutes a major axis in the activities of the Director General of Elections.

In its relentless efforts at perfecting and rendering the organisation of elections in Cameroon ever more credible, ELECAM set as its priority objective to update the voters' register for the election of Senators on 12 March 2022. The said register comprises municipal councillors and regional councillors, who, for the first time, were taking part in the polls as electors in their own right following their election in December 2020 and April 2021.

True to its strategy, the Directorate General of Elections took preliminary measures, both at its branches and central services, to collect updated data and consolidate the electoral register.

In this way, drawing up the list of senatorial electors started at the beginning of 2022, with active contribution from mayors and presidents of regional councils. Upon the convening of the electoral college on 13 January 2023, technical teams entrusted with this task undertook minor corrections rendered necessary by the progressive gathering of final data from the field. In conformity with the provisions of Section 224 (3)

of the Electoral Code, the publication of the lists of senatorial electors drawn and updated was done 30 (thirty) days before election day; followed by the production and distribution of voter cards.

In concrete terms, updating the register went through 3 (three) phases, namely update of the consolidated register of senatorial electors, printing and publication of the register of senatorial electors, and then production of voter cards, followed by their distribution.

SECTION I: UPDATING THE REGISTER OF SENATORIAL ELECTORS

In conformity with the provisions of Section 221 (1) of the Electoral Code, senators are elected by municipal councillors and regional councillors. These authorities elected respectively during the 9 February 2020 twin legislative and municipal election, the 6 December 2020 election of regional councillors, and the 4 April 2021 election of regional councillors comprised a voters' register of **11 505** electors pending clean-up, representing **10 605** municipal councillors, **873** regional councillors and **27** serving both as municipal and regional councillors.

Update of this register aimed, for the most part, to identify, verify and, eventually, strike off names of electors who have passed on, those that have lost their electoral qualification, those with an imprisonment sentence, those under pain of in-

compatibility as well as those who have resigned.

Beyond these operations, clerical errors were corrected and the biographical information of certain electors updated.

In this respect, the method of work involved getting in touch with a maximum number of electors for the purpose of confirming that they were still effectively serving their mandate and that their biographical as well biometric data conform to the voters' register. The result of all these checks made on the field was then forwarded progressively to the head office for consolidation and update, where necessary.

Upon completion of this operation, 371 electors were struck off from the register for various reasons as follows:

- 364 deaths, including 330 municipal councillors, 30 regional councillors and 4 serving both as municipal and regional councillors;
- 7 municipal councils who had resigned, including 2 who held positions incompatible with their term of office and 5 for sundry reasons.

At the end, the updated register of senatorial electors comprised **11 134** electors, including **10 268** municipal councillors, **843** regional councillors, and **23** electors serving a dual term of office, a peculiarity being that their names only appeared once in the voters' register. It must be indicated that the final electors were distributed per gender as follows:

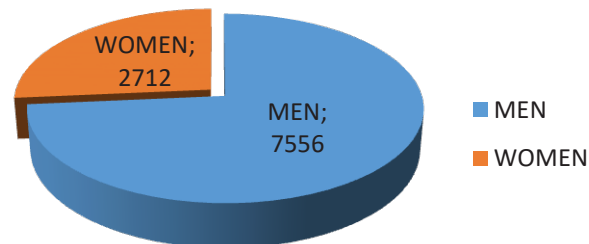
- 8 216 men, including 7 556 municipal councillors, 643 regional councillors and 17 serving a dual term of office, making 73.80%;
- 2 918 women, including 2 712 municipal councillors, 200 regional councillors and 6 serving a dual term of office, making 26.20%.

Finally, 770 electors were found to be less than 35 years old and 52 electors living with a disability, including 47 with motion disability and 5 with visual disability.

Distribution of electors per region, term of office, gender and political party:

Municipal councillors

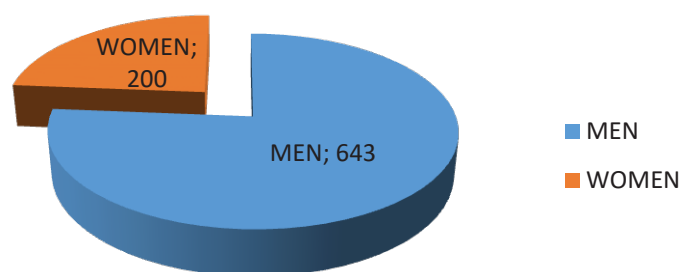
REGION	MEN	WOMEN	TOTAL
ADAMAWA	455	111	566
CENTRE	1 308	586	1 894
EAST	615	212	827
FAR NORTH	1 196	284	1 480
LITTORAL	737	262	999
NORTH	540	133	673
NORTH-WEST	743	301	1 044
WEST	854	315	1 169
SOUTH	511	234	745
SOUTH-WEST	597	274	871
GRAND TOTAL	7 556	2 712	10 268



Distribution per gender of municipal councillors

Regional councillors

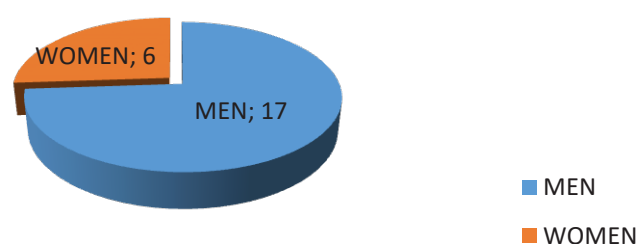
REGION	MEN	WOMEN	TOTAL
ADAMAWA	66	15	81
CENTRE	66	23	89
EAST	64	22	86
FAR NORTH	66	18	84
LITTORAL	65	20	85
NORTH	69	17	86
NORTH-WEST	61	22	83
WEST	60	16	76
SOUTH	62	23	85
SOUTH-WEST	64	24	88
GRAND TOTAL	643	200	843



Distribution per gender of regional councillors

Serving as both municipal and regional councillors

REGION	MEN	WOMEN	TOTAL
ADAMAWA	6	1	7
CENTRE	0	0	0
EAST	1	0	1
FAR NORTH	2	0	2
LITTORAL	2	0	2
NORTH	0	1	1
NORTH-WEST	0	0	0
WEST	5	4	9
SOUTH	1	0	1
SOUTH-WEST	0	0	0
GRAND TOTAL	17	6	23



Distribution per gender of electors serving two terms of office

Number of municipal councillors and regional councillors per political party

Political party	Number of municipal councillors	Number of regional councillors	Total
NADP	11	0	11
FDC	1	0	1
CNSF	168	2	170
MANIDEM	1	0	1
MDR	89	0	89
MP	2	0	2
MPCN	48	0	48
MPCC	3	0	0
MCNC	18	0	18
PAL	5	0	5
CNRP	178	0	178
UPSR	3	0	3
CPDM	8 877	584	9 461
SDF	151	0	151
CDU	157	17	174
UMS	50	0	50
NUDP	504	76	580
UNIVERS	2	0	2

SECTION II: PRINTING AND PUBLISHING REGISTERS OF SENATORIAL ELECTORS

Registers of senatorial electors were printed and published after convening of the electoral college, in compliance with the provisions of Section 224 (3) of the Electoral Code, which provides that the updated register of senatorial electors be published 30 (thirty) days before the polling day.

Prior to the printing of these registers, polling stations had to be created and electors assigned thereto within every divisional headquarters.

The criteria for assigning electors to these polling stations took into

account the nature of this election that concerns a fairly low number of electors in comparison to direct elections.

Other than this aspect, observance of the COVID-19 preventive measures prescribed by Government and the relatively old age of the electors were of great concern in terms of fluidity of the voting operations; hence the option to set the highest number of electors per polling station between 50 and 60 electors.

Altogether, 198 polling stations were created in the 58 divisions and electors assigned thereto in conformity with Decision No 000028/D/ELECAM/DGE of 17 February 2023 signed by the DGE to lay down and

set up the organisation and functioning of polling stations for the 12 March election of Senators (see Annex 9).

Having created the polling stations and assigned electors thereto, attention then riveted to printing the registers of senatorial electors, which involved two phases.

The first phase had to do with printing the updated lists of senatorial electors to be posted up at every ELECAM regional delegation 30 (thirty) days before the polls in accordance with Section 224 (3) of the Electoral Code.

Phase two, carried out within the 10 (ten) day period preceding the election, consisted in printing two kinds of lists of senatorial electors for each of the 198 polling stations: one for posting up in front of the polling station and another for signature of voters on polling day.

Drawing up of the lists of senatorial electors and the subsequent production of voter cards provided specifications on the quantity of election material and documents to be put at the disposal of polling stations.

SECTION III: PRODUCING AND DISTRIBUTING VOTER CARDS

The production of voter cards started right after the printing and publication of updated lists of senatorial electors. Prior to this activity, a specimen voter card was chosen, bearing in mind that such card was to serve only for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators.

Having undertaken the agreed lay out retained and put into place

the requisite logistics, notably printers and the proper accoutrements, voter cards corresponding to the updated register were then printed. After which, they were crosschecked to ensure their quality and conformity, and then classified per polling station in view of their packaging and conveyance to the different constituencies.

Pursuant to Section 226 (1) of the Electoral Code, voter cards were distributed within 20 (twenty) days prior to the polls. Moreover, voter cards not distributed within the said deadline were returned to ELECAM divisional branches to be made available on polling day in view of allowing for easy withdrawal by their holders.

While managing the register of senatorial electors, ELECAM strove to render election material available.

CHAPTER II: PROCUREMENT OF ELECTION MATERIAL

Election material is a capital component in the organisation of any election. For that reason, its availability in good time is essential to the smooth functioning of polling stations. Such material mostly includes polling booths, indelible ink, ballot boxes, seals, paper and lamps. Thus, before procuring election material for any election, an inventory must be made aimed, on the one hand, to know the quantity and quality of material available in stock and, on the other hand, to identify needs in view of guaranteeing its availability within the statutory deadlines.

SECTION I: TAKING STOCK OF THE EXISTING ELECTION MATERIAL

Due to preparations began long before the polls by the Directorate General of Elections, the competent services conducted an inventory within its logistics base and at ELECAM branches to find out the quantities of material on hand and its condition.

Findings at the end of this inventory revealed that certain material like ballot boxes and polling booths were available in good quantity and condition, to ensure a smooth conduct of the looming election of Senators.

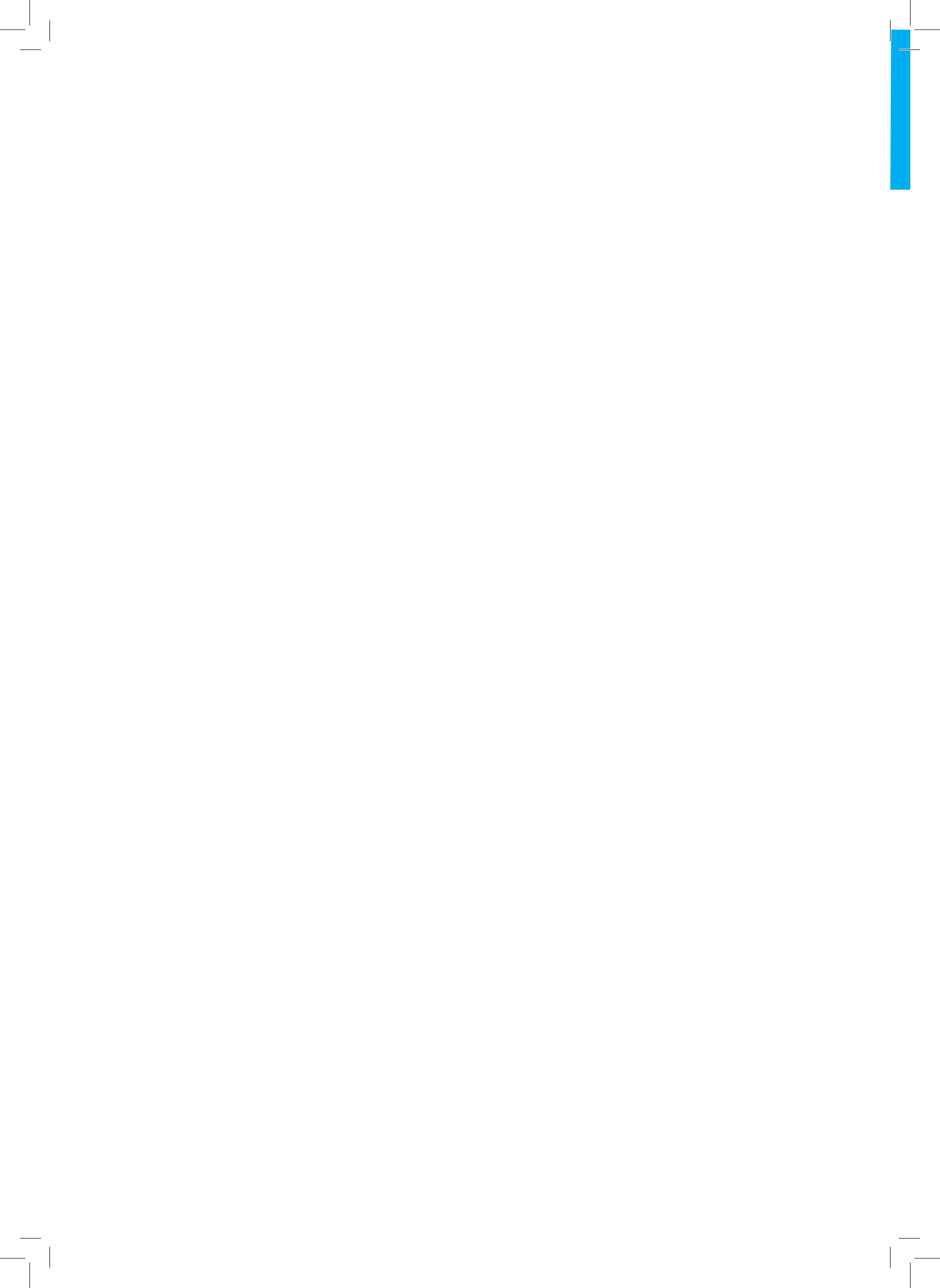
On the other hand, other material was either not available or useless and a timely order for the quantity required was therefore placed to ensure their availability at the right time.

SECTION II: ORDERING AND RECEIVING ELECTION MATERIAL

The order for additional election material took into account the available stock and the evaluation of requisite needs for this election. The said order notably included paper, calculators, pens, date stamps, ink pads, solar lamps, markers, scissors, tissue paper and disposal bags.

Upon reception, the paper was put at the disposal of printing press outfits for the production of election documents such as ballot papers or election report forms. Other material was used to design kits for the functioning of polling stations and joint electoral commissions.

At the same time, the election management body drew up a communication strategy to inform, educate, sensitise and guide other stakeholders, electors and public opinion as a whole on conduct of process.



CHAPTER III: PRE-ELECTION COMMUNICATION

ELECAM conducted an intensive communication drive to keep the public constantly abreast of preparations for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators. The strategy put in place consisted in carrying out actions and activities to keep the public, in general, and stakeholders of the electoral process, in particular, up-to-date. In this way, actions undertaken as part of the communication plan involved making ELECAM activities the focus of media attention, on the one hand, and raising voter awareness as well as ensuring voter education, on the other hand.

SECTION I: DRAWING MEDIA ATTENTION TO ELECAM ACTIVITIES

Drawing media attention was the cornerstone of the ELECAM communication strategy. In view of informing senatorial electors and other stakeholders of the electoral process, a good number of messages and releases were inserted in newspapers and radio or TV spots. These focused notably on:

- availability of electoral registers and voter cards;
- lists of polling stations as well as assignment of electors thereto;
- standard size of election campaign posters and procedure for publication of campaign documents;
- size of ballot papers and campaign ballots.

Similarly, in close collaboration with classical and digital media, co-

verage was ensured in the form of live or differed broadcast of the following events:

- sessions as of right of the Electoral Board;
- reception of candidacy files;
- publication of the lists of candidates retained by the Electoral Board;
- field trips undertaken by Members of the Electoral Board to supervise preparations for the polls;
- consultations between ELECAM and other stakeholders of the electoral process;
- conveyance of election material and documents to ELECAM branches;
- election campaign;
- capacity-building workshop for ELECAM staff and members of the different electoral commissions;
- meeting between ELECAM and accredited national as well as accredited international election observers;
- interviews granted by the Chairperson of the Electoral Board and the Director General of Elections in audio-visual media and print media.

Also, with a view to boost the visibility and image of ELECAM, a logo was designed for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators and adorned on many communication tools, notably the media kit in the form of a

magazine that included an extract of provisions of the Electoral Code applicable to the election of Senators. There were also customised gadgets “12 March 2023 Election of Senators” (pens, USB keys, shopping bags, pins, key holders and badges), information and voter education banners, awareness backdrops, a regularly updated interactive poster totem in which images and videos on preparatory activities for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators were inserted on regular basis as well as a high definition top-of-the-art interactive screen used during the ceremony held to publish the lists of candidates.

It is worth recalling that all ELECAM digital platforms like Facebook, Twitter, YouTube and the ELECAM and media WhatsApp group were used to keep track of the above campaigns, with a daily posting of information online to raise awareness and educate voters on the electoral process.

SECTION II: RAISING VOTER AWARENESS AND EDUCATING VOTERS

In concrete terms, the purpose here was to produce and broadcast audio-visual micro-programmes like ELECAM Mag, Web Animation and Fréquence ELECAM, in view of sensitising and educating the public at large as well as members of the electoral college, in particular, on the need for a massive and inclusive participation in the 12 March 2023 election of Senators. Thanks to voter-inducement campaign for the election of Senators on 12 March 2023 carried out on daily basis, senatorial elec-

tors were called upon to crosscheck their names on the updated electoral registers and posted up, in view of possible complaints, as well as to withdraw their voter cards at ELECAM divisional branches.

A series of campaigns were also launched to encourage members of the electoral college to turn out and vote. These included a poster and awareness campaign as well as a special digital campaign. In actual fact, for the purpose of educating and raising awareness of the different ELECAM targets via digital platforms on the election of Senators on 12 March 2023, the institution, with support from certain influencers, conducted an intensive campaign on social media through digital platforms like Facebook, Twitter, YouTube and TikTok. Cybernetic campaigns, launched on these social media also included Web animations.

ELECAM equally carried on an awareness campaign via posters to ensure greater participation of social-vulnerable groups in the electoral process.

CHAPTER IV: INCLUSION OF VULNERABLE AND MINORITY GROUPS

The credibility of an electoral process is also and mostly measured by its inclusive nature that must match the established standards in the domain. This is why ELECAM ensures that vulnerable social groups should have equal and equitable access vis-à-vis the other categories of electors. Moreover, significant and high-impact actions accomplished in this domain by Elections Cameroon over the years have earned many rewards for the institution in the form of awards won on the international scene, thereby making the institution a reference in that domain.

To guarantee the inclusive nature of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, special measures were taken at all phases of the electoral process to ensure proper consideration of groups considered as socially-vulnerable such as women, persons with a disability, minorities and indigenous people.

SECTION I: CONSIDERING GENDER AND ELECTORS WITH A DISABILITY

A- CONSIDERING GENDER

The mandatory consideration of sociological components and gender while compiling lists of candidates is prescribed by Section 218 (3) of the Electoral Code. Elections Cameroon took the opportunity afforded by the 12 March 2023 election of Senators to intensify actions towards improving women's representativeness in the electoral process. In this regard, special emphasis placed on this legal requirement during the compilation of

lists of candidates as well as women's representation in local polling commissions. In the same vein, regional supervisory commissions and the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes also applied this gender parity.

B- CONSIDERING ELECTORS WITH A DISABILITY

Actions were taken in favour of persons with a disability to facilitate and encourage their effective participation in all phases of the 12 March election of Senators, notably:

- a systematic headcount of all electors with a disability;
- construction of access ramps at some polling stations to ease access for electors with motion disability on polling day;
- production of braille ballot paper labels as well as mini braille posters for electors with visual impairment;
- provision of sign language interpreters at some polling stations to enable a more fluid communication with members of the electoral college who are hard of hearing or deaf-mute;
- consideration of these categories in all ELECAM messages and communication tools.

SECTION II: CONSIDERING MINORITIES AND INDIGENOUS PEOPLE

Just like was the case with other elections by list system, consideration of the representation of all sociological components was a legal requirement for all lists of candidates submitted for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators. The Electoral Board made sure of this while examining candidacy files.

CHAPTER V: MANAGEMENT OF CANDIDACY FILES AND PRE-ELECTION DISPUTES

Candidacy files for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators went through 3 (three) main phases during their management:

- reception of candidacy files;
- examination of candidacy files and publication of lists of candidates;
- petitions related to lists of candidates.

SECTION I: RECEIVING CANDIDACY FILES

In conformity with the combined provisions of **Sections 164, 165, 166 and 231** of the Electoral Code, nomination papers were either submitted at the Directorate General of Elections or at branches of Elections Cameroon, though all the political parties in the race waited for the final day, which was **28 February 2023**, before submitting their nomination papers.

A total of 13 (thirteen) political parties submitted nomination papers, making 32 (thirty-two) lists of candidates, namely **NADP, FDC, CNSF, JDC, MDR, CPNR, CPDM, SDF, UCDI, CDU, UMS, NU DP** and **UPC** (find the corresponding details on the table found under Annex 11).

After issuing submission receipts and summary slips for documents received to the representatives of these political parties, bearers of every nomination paper, the Directorate General of Elections forwarded the said papers to the Electoral Board for examination and publication of the

lists of candidates retained.

SECTION II: EXAMINING CANDIDACY FILES AND PUBLISHING LISTS OF CANDIDATES

In application of provisions of Section 10 (2) of the Electoral Code, the Electoral Board set down to scrutinise the candidacy files received from the Directorate General of Elections and, on 7 February 2023, at the end of which it adopted **Resolutions No 02/R/ELECAM/CE and No 03/R/ELECAM/CE** to publish the lists accepted and to reject certain lists of candidates for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators 2023, respectively (see Annexes 2 and 3).

Out of the 32 (thirty-two) lists of candidates examined, 22 (twenty-two) were accepted and 10 (ten) rejected. Given that the acceptance or rejection could be liable to complaints before the election judge, several petitions were lodged before the Constitutional Council.

SECTION III: MANAGING PETITIONS RELATED TO LIST OF CANDIDATES

Following the publication of the lists of candidates accepted and notification of those concerned by Resolution No 03/R/ELECAM/CE of 7 February 2023 to reject their candidacy files, 13 (thirteen) petitions were lodged at the Constitutional Council by political parties to challenge the Electoral Board resolutions (find these petitions and their motives on the recap table under Annex 12).

After examination of the petitions and factums in reply, the Constitutional Council, in its public hearing of petitions related to lists of candidates, held on **15 February 2023**, rejected the **13 (thirteen)** petitions, thereby confirming the Electoral Board resolutions.

In conclusion, of the initial 13 (thirteen) political parties that submitted candidacy files, only 10 (ten) were authorised to take part in the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, namely **NADP, FDC, CNSF, MDR, CPNR, CPDM, SDF, CDU, UMS** and **NUDP**.

With this specification on the exact number of lists of candidates and given that the exact number of polling stations was already known, ELECAM then focused on the production of election documents.

CHAPTER VI: CONCEPTION AND PRINTING OF ELECTION DOCUMENTS

Defined as tools absolutely essential to a smooth conduct of polls, election documents are indispensable to the implementation of any electoral process. Their availability in quality and enough quantity is top-most in the organisational strategy that requires a careful monitoring to ensure the success of any election.

As concerns the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, ELECAM started by identifying, and then conceiving the said documents, before ensuring their printing per se, in view of meeting the statutory deadlines for deployment of the election documents.

SECTION I: IDENTIFYING AND CONCEIVING ELECTION DOCUMENTS

Election documents essential to the 12 March 2023 election of Senators were identified and conceived as part of preparations carried out by the Directorate General of Elections prior to the convening of the electoral college.

In this vein, a review of election documents essential to conduct of the said election led to the identification, among others, of vital documents: election proceedings report forms for the different electoral commissions, counting sheets, ballot papers, envelopes, the decision to lay down and set up the organisation and functioning of polling stations as well as various types of guide (electors, local polling commission chairpersons, observers).

Apart from carrying out a quan-

titative evaluation of these documents per constituency on the basis of a projection of the number of electors and lists in the election race, these documents were designed with a view to adapt them to the specific nature of the election of Senators. In this regard, ELECAM found it necessary to conceive a standard election proceedings report form for the regional supervisory commissions as well as another for the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes. Such innovations enabled the said commissions to work faster and more effectively and allowed for a much easier analysis of election reports drawn up on their different proceedings.

In short, besides the fact that certain ballot papers required some prerequisites, particularly the choice of colours, symbols and logos, all the other election documents were identified and conceived prior to publication of the decree convening the electoral college. Thus, to finalise their conception, ELECAM had to wait for an official date to be set for the election, which was later done in the decree mentioned above.

Once this prerequisite was satisfied, printing of these election documents could then start.

SECTION II: PRINTING ELECTION DOCUMENTS

The election documents were printed in 2 (two) phases. The first took place shortly after the electoral college was convened and concerned the following documents:

- election report forms for electoral commissions;
- counting sheets;
- decision of the DGE to lay down and set up the organisation and functioning of polling stations;
- various guides and various manuals as well as large-size envelopes.

Phase two was set into motion after publication of the lists of candidates accepted by the Electoral Board and consolidation of the voters' register. Indeed, these two operations are prerequisites that allow for a final evaluation of what election material and documents to print. In regard to all these documents, in general, and ballot papers, in particular, before proceeding with mass printing, ELECAM had to validate a specimen to ensure conformity with the form and information contained thereupon. Upon completing the checks, representatives of the lists in the election race were invited to confirm the accuracy of information contained thereupon, including the colour and logo chosen, prior to printing.

In conformity with the Electoral Code, ballot papers, increased to a quarter, were printed for each of the

198 polling stations. Likewise, campaign ballots were printed and put at the disposal of political parties in good time, in proportion to the number of lists submitted. Voting envelopes were also printed, alongside a reserve stock for distribution per polling station.

In addition to these election documents, election report forms meant for the different electoral commissions, counting sheets and large-size envelopes were printed.

Three weeks before the election, all the documents were available and ready for packaging and conveyance to constituencies.

CHAPTER VII: PACKAGING AND CONVEYANCE OF ELECTION MATERIAL

For this 12 March 2023 election of Senators, packaging and conveyance of election material and documents was accomplished in conformity with the logistics plan drawn up beforehand. This plan organised the teams assigned to the said activity, the method adopted for constituting kits and conveyance of the kits to the various constituencies.

SECTION I: ORGANISING WORKING TEAMS

The teams set aside to ensure packaging and conveyance of election material and documents were put to work, organised in pools, got down to work, with a view to ensure suitable packaging and conveyance of the election material and document kits towards polling stations. Given the fairly low volume of work to be done, only staff members at the Directorate General of Elections were co-opted into the pools at the logistics base, located for the circumstance at the head office of ELECAM.

Altogether, 10 (ten) pools were set to work, namely:

- computer pool;
- packaging pool;
- election material storage and provision pool;
- election kit inspection and validation pool;
- election material loading, escorting and conveyance pool;

- monitoring, communication and liaison with Branches pool;
- liaison with printing press outfits pool;
- centralisation and consolidation of documents pool;
- reporting and archiving pool;
- vehicle chartering pool.

SECTION II: METHOD OF WORK FOR THE TEAMS

A working method tailored to meet the goals of each pool was adopted, with each team expected to master and observe it in strict compliance with the prescribed deadlines. This enabled packaging of the different types of kits, namely:

- functioning kits for polling stations and electoral commissions comprising seals, pens, indelible ink, chalk, badges;
- election documents kits made up of election report forms, ballot papers, voting envelopes, large-size envelopes, counting sheets;
- senatorial electors guidance kits composed of chasubles and badges;
- COVID-19 kits comprising hand sanitizers and face masks.

A total of **866 (eight hundred and sixty-six)** kits were packaged, inspected and validated, broken down as follows:

- 256 functioning kits, including 198 for polling stations and 58 as reserve stocks;
- 266 election documents kits, including 199 for polling stations,

- 58 as reserve stocks and 10 voter payment documents kits;
- 58 senatorial electors guidance kits;
- 256 COVID-19 kits, including 198 for polling stations and 58 as reserve stocks;
- 20 kits, including 10 for material and 10 for documents meant for regional supervisory commissions;
- 10 kits, comprising chasubles for local polling commission chairpersons.

SECTION III: CONVEYING KITS TO ELECAM BRANCHES

Pursuant to the conveyance plan adopted, all the packaged kits were conveyed towards ELECAM regional delegations, which, in turn, dispatched them to divisional branches where polling stations were located.

All the election material and documents kits were conveyed to branches hitch-free and in good time, paving the way for training of the different actors tasked with their usage.

CHAPTER VIII: CAPACITY-BUILDING OF ELECTION AGENTS

Capacity-building is mandatory in any electoral process, for elections come and go, but are never the same, given that each election has its specificities. Training for election agents in view of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators followed a training plan that opted for trickle-down trainings running from 23 February to 3 March 2023. In this way, training teams were put to task with a view to train ELECAM branch staff, who, in turn, trained election agents in their respective territorial units. This chapter is sub-divided into 2 (two) sections; one centres on training of Elections Cameroon staff (Section I), and the other on training of electoral commission chairpersons and members (Section II).

SECTION I: DEVELOPING THE CAPACITIES OF STAFF

A training of trainers session held on 15 February 2023 for ELECAM staff in Yaounde, where some sixty officials and employees at the ELECAM central services were trained, including staff/members of the sub-commissions for training, and, for centralisation of the election results, personnel likely to be chosen as members of regional supervisory commissions and the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes as well as security officials. For this purpose, participants were trained on the following modules:

- legal and institutional framework for the election of Senators;
- material organisation and functioning of polling stations within the framework of an indirect election;

- functioning of regional supervisory commissions (RSC), system of election and procedure for awarding seats applicable to the election of Senators and computer tool for monitoring voting operations and calculating the election results;
- method and techniques for facilitating election training workshops;
- security tips during an election period.

This training had as objective to bring participants up to the same level of understanding of the themes concerned, on the one hand, and to offer them useful training techniques for their mission in the branches. On the other hand, the training aimed at familiarising all participants with election matters and basic notions on securing their immediate vicinity during an election period. This training of trainers was also an opportunity for participants to study and go through model election report forms for every electoral commission.

These same training modules were later replicated to ELECAM branch staff at the level of every regional headquarters between 23 February and 3 March 2023 by training teams from the Directorate General of Elections. At this level, regional delegates, regional service heads, divisional branch heads and computer bureau heads received training on all the modules above, and were then tasked to train the local polling commission chairpersons and members in their respective territorial units.

SECTION II: TRAINING JOINT ELECTORAL COMMISSION MEMBERS

Three types of electoral commissions play a role in the election of Senators:

- Local Polling Commissions (LPC);
- Regional Supervisory Commissions (RSC); and
- National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes (NCFCV).

Under this circumstance, chairpersons and members of the first two commissions were trained in the workshops organised in branches. As a matter of fact, RSC chairpersons and members took full part in the training offered to ELECAM staff. As for LPC chairpersons, they were trained by ELECAM divisional branch heads on: "material organisation and functioning of polling stations within the framework of an indirect election". Each divisional branch head ensured training of the local polling commissions within their area of competence at the divisional headquarters. An innovation in this training was the inclusion of representatives of political parties in the sessions reserved for electoral commission chairpersons and members.

Moreover, it must be pointed out that members of the NCFCV were drilled on how to fill the election report of their commission as well as on analysis of election reports received from regional supervisory commissions. In fact, this document, conceived and produced by ELECAM to ease and harmonise the work of this crown commission, was amply explained to its users.

A total of **1 029 (one thousand and twenty-nine)** ELECAM workers and electoral commission members were trained on the 5 (five) modules retained, representing 772 (seven hundred and seventy-two) local polling commission chairpersons, 91 (ninety-one) regional supervisory commission chairpersons and members that included the 10 (ten) regional delegates of ELECAM, 58 (fifty-eight) divisional branch heads, 50 (fifty) regional service heads and 58 (fifty-eight) computer bureau heads. Added to the sixty or more participants in the training of trainers held in Yaounde on 21 February 2023, election agents trained in regions rose to **1 089 (one thousand and eighty-nine)** persons trained ahead of this election of 12 March 2023.

In view of enabling the trained election agents not to forget the notions learned, this training was organised close to the said election, during the election campaign.

CHAPTER IX: MANAGEMENT OF THE ELECTION CAMPAIGN

The most important phase in the electoral process, the election campaign opened in conformity with law, on the 15th day prior to the election of 12 March 2023, which is Saturday, 25 February 2023 and ended on the eve on the polls, at midnight. It allowed the different political parties to meet the electorate composed of municipal councillors and regional councillors, in view of winning their votes through their various manifestos.

As a prelude to the campaign, the Director General of Elections took a series of measures to ensure its smooth conduct and monitoring.

SECTION I: MEASURES TAKEN BY THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF ELECTIONS

Two (2) key measures were taken by the Director General of Election to ease the conduct of this election campaign, namely 2 (two) regulatory texts fixing the size of ballot papers and campaign ballots as well as the maximum size of campaign posters, on the one hand, and making available campaign ballots, on the other hand.

As concerns the regulatory texts, the Director General of Elections signed **Decision No 000018/D/ELECAM/DGE on 10 February 2023**, to fix the maximum size for election campaign posters and procedure for publishing campaign documents (Annex 7), followed by **Decision No 000019/D/ELECAM/DGE** to fix the size of ballot papers and campaign ballots (Annex 8).

Regarding campaign ballot, acting in conformity with provisions of **Section 88** (1) of the Electoral Code, the Director General of Elections put at the disposal of each of the political parties in the race campaign ballots in proportion to the number of lists of candidates submitted.

SECTION II: MONITORING THE ELECTION CAMPAIGN

In application of the texts taken by the Director General of Elections, officials of Elections Cameroon made sure that campaign posters, circulars and manifestos were submitted for prior endorsement as prescribed by Section 89 (1) of the Electoral Code. Such endorsement was issued at the Directorate General of Elections and at branches of Elections Cameroon. In the same vein, municipal councils were solicited to set aside spots where the political parties in the race could post their campaign posters.

Monitoring of this election campaign was equally ensured by security measures taken by MINAT and administrative authorities, on the one hand, and MINCOM as well as CNC, on the other hand, in view of an equitable access to public media for these political parties. In most cases, the political parties showed proof of decorum, maturity and observance of the rules governing conduct of the election campaign, still under the supervision of the Electoral Board.

CHAPTER X: CONTROL AND SUPERVISION BY THE ELECTORAL BOARD

Tasked with the statutory control and supervision of the electoral process, the Electoral Board (EB), within the framework of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, carried out its Republican activities through the holding of sessions as of right (Section I), organisation of field controls (Section II) and holding of consultations with other stakeholders of the electoral process (Section III).

SECTION I: SESSIONS OF THE ELECTORAL BOARD

In conformity with Section 19 (2) of the Electoral Code whereby *“The Electoral Board shall meet at least once every fortnight upon the convening of the electorate”*, the Electoral Board held 5 (five) sessions as of right relating to the election of Senators on 12 March 2023.

The first session as of right took place on 18 January 2023 and focussed mainly on the adoption of an action plan for the Electoral Board and the Directorate General of Elections, terms of reference for field trips in view of preliminary controls and distribution as well as scheduling of the election.

Thanks to the stand-by committee put in place by the Chairperson of the Electoral Board and the Vice-Chairperson of the Electoral Board following the convening of the electoral college, candidacy files submitted within the statutory time-limit at the Directorate General of Elections were received by the Chairperson of the Electoral Board.

The latter instantly organised preparations for a session devoted to the scrutiny of these files.

Thus, the second session as of right of the Electoral Board, opened on 1 February 2023, centred, among others, on adopting a working method and distribution of groups as well as opening of deliberations per se for examination of the candidacy files by members of the Electoral Board. These deliberations came to an end on 7 February 2023 with publication of the lists of candidates accepted.

The third session as of right, held on 7 March 2023, had as main objective the solemn publication by the Electoral Board of the lists of candidates accepted. This session also had as goal the communication forthwith of reasons for the rejection to the Directorate General of Elections in view of notification of the candidates concerned. Finally, this involved ensuring transmission of the said resolutions to the Constitutional Council such as to facilitate the opening and conduct of hearings on petitions related to the lists of candidates.

Since no petitions relating to the lists of candidates prevailed before the Constitutional Council, this court concluded hearings on 19 February 2023. Subsequently, the fourth session as of right of the Electoral Board held on 23 February 2023, with as main item the adoption of terms of reference for the supervision of polls per se by members of the Elec-

toral Board. Signature of the decision of the Chairperson of the Electoral Board to approve composition of the 10 (ten) Regional Supervisory Commissions, as well as examination and adoption of the resolution to approve composition of the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes. In accordance with the provisions of Sections 235 and 238 of the Electoral Code, respectively.

On 29 March 2023, in the aftermath of the proclamation by Constitutional Council of final results of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, the Electoral Board held its fifth session as of right, in view of taking stock and conducting an exhaustive evaluation of lessons learned from the said election, accompanied by a general synthesis of the supervision trips made by members of the Electoral Board on the field during the 12 March 2023 election of Senators.

SECTION II: HOLDING A NATIONAL CONSULTATION WITH STAKEHOLDERS OF THE ELECTORAL PROCESS

In conformity with Section 11 (2) of the Electoral Code, the Electoral Board holds consultations with the Administration, judiciary, political parties and the civil society within the framework of the management of the electoral process.

In view of a more effective organisation of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, the Electoral Board held a consultation, 24 February 2023, at the Mont FEBE Hotel in Yaounde, on the theme “For a credible, se-

cure, inclusive and appeased election” with other stakeholders of the electoral process. The purpose of this consultation was to undertake a common analysis of challenges and stakes involved in this election, on the one hand, and to evaluate possible solutions for difficulties that may occur before, during and after the polls, on the other hand, through the adoption of the Code of Best Practices, such as to harmonise and further strengthen collaboration with the different stakeholders.

The said consultation, organised on the eve of election campaigns, witnessed the massive participation of all the stakeholders concerned. Together, they strove to identify and define stakes and repercussions of the security crises on the electoral process; identify the best practices to adopt as well as key catalysts of trust in the electorate; agree on actions to undertake for a credible, secure, inclusive and appeased election; brainstorm on the impact of actions accomplished by each and every one, including ELECAM, to preserve a harmonious electoral environment; examine legal, technical and operational aspects likely to undermine the integrity and transparency of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators; and finally, to perfect the understanding of stakeholders regarding the stakes and challenges of the senatorial elections; before appropriating the key role of everyone in implementing the fundamental principles of democratic fair-

play, the goal being to significantly mitigate the propensity for pre- and post-election.

At the end of this consultation, held on 24 February 2023, on a note of general satisfaction, the stakeholders of the electoral process present ratified the Code of Best Practices and a copy (in the two official languages) was shared out.

SECTION III: FIELD TRIPS

In application of Section 10 (1) of the Electoral Code, the Electoral Board ensures compliance with electoral law by all stakeholders for the purpose of guaranteeing regular, free, fair, transparent and credible polls.

Accomplishment of this Republican mission particularly involves, as stipulated by Section 10 (2) of the same Code, a proximity supervision of the entire electoral process. This takes the form, among others, of field trips conducted by members of the Electoral Board in the different constituencies, and which are placed under the operational coordination of divisional branches of Elections Cameroon.

In this regard, the first trip took place from 19 to 29 January 2023 and had as general objective controlling and supervising preparations for the election at ELECAM Branch (EB) level. More specifically, members had to monitor the ongoing update of the voters' register, assess the socio-political atmosphere as well as the mindset of staff.

The second and final field trip, running from 4 to 16 March 2023, involved supervising the election campaign and finalising preparations in every constituency. This trip also afforded Members of the Electoral Board an opportunity to hold discussions with local administrative authorities on security measures before, during and after polling day.

CHAPTER XI: SECURING OF THE ELECTORAL PROCESS

The success of any election requires maximal security. The current socio-political climate, at the national, sub-regional and even global levels, imposes security challenges that require a synergy of actions on the part of all stakeholders in the electoral process. The guarantee of a peaceful and secure environment before, during and after the 12 March 2023 elections thus depends on a series of security measures taken by the Government and ELECAM.

SECTION I: PUTTING GENERAL SECURITY MEASURES IN PLACE

The State of Cameroon, through the Ministry of Territorial Administration and the heads of security and defence forces, took a series of measures to ensure the safety of the population and all stakeholders in the electoral process for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators. In this light, reinforced security plans were drawn up and implemented in all regions, in order to ensure security throughout all phases in this electoral process.

In the pre-electoral phase, security forces were called upon to perform static and dynamic functions, as well as to form standby forces that could intervene where necessary.

The objective was to ensure protection for individuals and property, secure transportation of the election material, sites for production and storage of material and equipment to be used in the election.

Security on polling day took the form of measures to guarantee

the security of voting operations. This involved reinforcing security for people, buildings and election material during the election. The security plan also covered the vote counting operations and necessary assistance during the transportation, forwarding and centralisation of results.

For the post-election phase, measures had to be taken to ensure security around premises hosting the deliberations of regional supervisory commissions and to provide guards at the residences of Electoral Board Members as well as some ELECAM branch officials.

SECTION II: PUTTING APPEASEMENT SECURITY MEASURES BY ELECAM IN PLACE

ELECAM put in place a security mechanism based on regular consultations with other stakeholders of the electoral process at national and local level with a view to prevent any form of electoral violence.

This option was translated into action through statutory missions of the Electoral Board, particularly its field trips across the country's ten regions, to exchange views with other stakeholders of the electoral process in order to dissipate misunderstandings and shadows likely to undermine the integrity of the election.

The Electoral Board also thought it wise to encourage and advocate as much as possible the adoption of best election practices through the holding of a consultation at national level with other stakeholders of

the electoral process, the objective being to limit violence and insecurity to the barest minimum before, during and after the elections.

In the same vein, ELECAM's offices remained open and accessible at all times throughout the electoral process, either through online consultations through free-toll numbers or on-site information and the easing of several other procedures.

These security measures contributed to a smooth conduct of the election operations, while consolidating the credibility, integrity and transparency of the election such as to satisfy the expectations and worries of election observers.

CHAPTER XII: COORDINATION OF THE ACTIVITIES OF ELECTION OBSERVERS

Election observation makes it possible to assess the credibility and sincerity of elections in absolute neutrality. It is regulated in Cameroon by the provisions of Sections 26 (1) and 296 of the Electoral Code, which recognise the possibility for ELECAM to collaborate with duly accredited election observers and the Director General of Elections is responsible for coordinating their actions. Like with previous elections, the 12 March 2023 election of Senators was subject to intense election observation activity by both national and international bodies. It is within this framework that the Director General of Elections conceived and put at their disposal the Practical Observers' Guide, during an information meeting held with accredited election observers, prior to their deployment on the field.

SECTION I: RECEIVING, ORIENTATING AND INFORMING ELECTION OBSERVERS

Under the chair of the Director General of Elections, the meeting between ELECAM and election observers was aimed at briefing the latter on the socio-political and security realities of the country and also to reassure them of measures taken for a smooth conduct of the election. This meeting was attended by the administrations involved in conduct of the electoral process, notably MINAT, MINREX, MINDDEVEL, MINCOM, SED and DGSN, NCC, NCHRF, whose representatives briefly explained their roles in the process.

Participants were also reminded of the general principles and fundamental rules of ethics as well as security applicable to election observation, notably independence, neutrality and observance of safety guidelines.

Fifty-six (56) representatives of election observation bodies, including 40 (forty) national and 16 (sixteen) international bodies took part in this meeting, which also recorded the attendance of some media organs. Kits consisting, amongst others, of a copy of the Election Observer's Guide and a copy of the Electoral Code were prepared and distributed to participants for use during their deployment.

SECTION II: ELECTION OBSERVERS DEPLOYING ON THE FIELD

On polling day, election observers covered all ten constituencies of the country.

They were able to access all 198 polling stations located in the divisional headquarters, on the sole condition that they present their accreditation badge issued by MINAT, the competent authority.

For this purpose, they benefited from the supervision and benevolent monitoring of ELECAM branch officials. This enabled them to accomplish their mission in a satisfactory manner. As proof, no breach or incident against them was reported before, during or after the poll.

Upon completion of their mission on the field, the election observers formulated certain recommendations:

- enable close collaboration with the Ministry of Territorial Administration, provide observers with electoral kits and relevant documentation in enough quantity within at least 14 days prior to the polls;
- intensify and broaden training and retraining to political parties, associations, ELECAM staff, forces of law and order as well as members of the Administration on all election-related themes;
- provide access paths to all voting centres for persons with a disability in future elections;
- raise the awareness of electors through public and private media on vote secrecy, the behaviour and attitude to display when inside any polling station;
- consider improving the voter enrolment process, with a view to guarantee an instant and on-the-spot issuance of voter cards;
- consider rendering a permanent consultation forum institutional for a lasting interaction with stakeholders, with a view to ensure an inclusive participation for the duration of the electoral cycle;
- put in place internal norms and procedures, in view of a more effective harmonious and consistent management of the collaboration framework with election observer missions and civil society organisations throughout the electoral process, more particularly on polling day;
- consider putting in place indicators and/or tools for getting the most out of best practices on polling day and for the duration of the electoral cycle; in view of upholding a high standard of service provision, vector and guarantor of effective added value to the electoral process as a whole;
- review and further modernise the procedure for appointing, training and deploying polling station agents, such as to make sure that the process is completely under the direct control of ELECAM.

PART III: CONDUCT OF THE POLL

On 12 March 2023, 11 134 (eleven thousand one hundred and thirty-four) regional and municipal councillors were expected to turn out and vote. The election took place in the 198 polling stations (PS) organised in accordance with the decision to lay down the organisation and function-

ing of polling stations. The Electoral Board (EB) supervised the voting, the results of which were centralised at the level of Regional Supervisory Commissions (RSCs) and the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes (NCFCV).

CHAPTER I: MATERIAL ORGANISATION OF POLLING STATIONS

Voting and most election operations take place in polling stations. Thus, polling stations must be the subject of a strict and careful organisation and functioning in order to circumvent the risks of any problems. Bearing this in mind, the Director General of Elections signed a decision to lay down and set up the organisation and functioning of polling stations as well as decisions to determine the list of polling stations and distribution of electors within them for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators (Section I). Moreover, polling stations located in divisional headquarters were laid out (Section III) accordingly and each provided with an operating kit (Section IV) managed by a local polling commission (Section II).

SECTION I: PUBLISHING THE LIST OF POLLING STATIONS

The list of polling stations for the 12 March 2023 election was the subject of ten (10) decisions (one per region) of the Director General of Elections, signed on 24 February 2023. Each decision was published and posted within the statutory deadlines at ELECAM regional delegations and divisional branches and council branches 15 (fifteen) days before the polls, in conformity with Sections 228 and 229 of the Electoral Code. The list of polling stations provides the name of the polling station, as well as the number of electors voting there.

SECTION II: ESTABLISHING THE COMPOSITION OF LOCAL POLLING COMMISSIONS

According to Section 54 of the Electoral Code, each local polling commission (LPC) must be composed of a chairperson, appointed by the Divisional Branch Head of ELECAM, and members appointed by the administration and political parties competing in the constituency concerned. This legal provision was respected during the 12 March 2023 election of Senators. This enabled ELECAM's Divisional Branch Heads to approve the composition of the local polling commissions within the statutory deadline. It is important to note that the chairpersons of local polling commissions were appointed from among personalities of good character and with a profile corresponding to the criteria previously defined by the Director General of Elections.

SECTION III: PREPARING AND RUNNING POLLING STATIONS

The polling stations retained for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators were located in public places and open to the public. For the most part, these were classrooms in schools located in divisional headquarters. Once their accessibility, crosschecked and confirmed by members of the Electoral Board, were adequately prepared to allow for a peaceful conduct of voting operations. In addition, substantial adjustments were made in polling

stations having electors with a disability to facilitate their voting.

Furthermore, payment counters were set up in rooms adjoining the polling stations to enable electors who had cast their ballots to collect their fees for participation in the polls.

It is important to note that all these arrangements were made in accordance with Decision No 000028/D/ELECAM/DGE of 17 February 2023 to lay down and set up the organisation and functioning of polling stations (Annex 9). A copy of this decision was included in the operating kit of each polling station.

SECTION IV: OPERATING KIT OF POLLING STATIONS

Every polling station operating kit includes election material and documents necessary for a proper functioning of the polling station. On the eve of polling day or a few hours before, the kits comprising election material and documents were handed over to chairpersons of local polling commissions to enable each of them get to their assigned polling stations and effectively open them at 8 am. These essential election material and documents were indeed available in sufficient quantity in the polling stations throughout the voting process, which ensured a smooth conduct of the election operations.

CHAPTER II: CONDUCT OF THE POLL

In regard to the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, just like with every election, all stakeholders and observers of the electoral process were focused on the conduct of voting operations in the 198 (one hundred and ninety-eight) polling stations located in divisional headquarters.

At ELECAM's level, all measures were taken beforehand to ensure timely opening of polling stations, smooth conduct of voting operations, closing of the poll and counting of votes.

SECTION I: OPENING POLLING STATIONS

In accordance with the decree convening the electoral college, polling stations opened at 8 am, throughout the country. No shortcomings were noted during this important phase of the election.

It should be noted that respect of the opening time for polling stations was at the heart of the training of local polling commission members. As a result, polling stations opened at exactly 8 a.m. as planned, and electors were able to access them and exercise their right to vote.

SECTION II: CONDUCTING THE VOTING PROCESS

Voting operations took place in a calm atmosphere. In all the constituencies, electors took part in the vote with great enthusiasm. This resulted in a high voter turnout, even in areas vulnerable to insecurity.

In addition to the measures taken to make the elector's circuit fluid, ELECAM deployed guides to each polling station, to facilitate the voting process. With great professionalism, they helped electors to easily identify their polling station.

Each elector was able to cast their vote in accordance with provisions of the Electoral Code relating to the conduct of voting operations. After voting, voters were directed to the offices set aside for payment of their fees for participation in the polls.

Difficulties without any impact on the voting process were nevertheless reported in a handful of polling stations. For example, in the Far North constituency, there was a problem with the proxy vote of an elector in custody pending trial. The said problem was resolved thanks to the mastery demonstrated by the local polling commission members concerned.

SECTION III: CLOSING POLLS

Due to the minor number of electors and fluidity of the voting process, all electors had already cast their vote by midday, in most polling stations. In the face of this, local polling commissions could not close the polls early, otherwise they would be liable to litigation. ELECAM took steps to prevent this from happening during the training of local polling commission chairpersons, by insisting on the need to allow voting to continue until the statutory closing time of 6 p.m., thus enabling local polling commission members to calmly carry on with vote counting operations.

Hence the press briefing of the Director General of Elections at the end of the counting operations.

SECTION IV: COUNTING VOTES

After the closure of polls in each polling station, preparations were immediately made to enable the local polling commission proceed with vote counting. Voting operations took place without any incident. Thus, results obtained in each polling station were made public in accordance with provisions of the Electoral Code. In each polling station, the local polling commission's election report, together with annexed documents, were immediately handed over to the competent Divisional Branch Head for onward transmission to the relevant Regional Delegation of Elections Cameroon and to the Regional Supervisory Commission concerned.

All these election operations, on election day, did not escape the attention and interest of the media.

CHAPTER III: COMMUNICATION ON POLLING DAY

The communication put in place on polling day consisted of media coverage of election operations and live broadcast of a press briefing by the Director General of Elections at the end of the said operations.

SECTION I: ENSURING MEDIA COVERAGE OF THE ELECTION

Once again, media coverage played an important role on election day. It was carried out by public and private media, which covered various polling stations, sometimes in the presence of Electoral Board Members, the Director General of Elections and the accredited election observers.

SECTION II: ISSUING A PRESS BRIEFING

On the evening of election day, the Director General of Elections reported on the conduct of the election in the presence of representatives of the national and international media. This was done through a live broadcasts in the 2 (two) official languages, in English and French, on television and radio stations. The Director General of Elections commended the respect by all stakeholders of the opening and closing time for polls as well as the effective organisation and supervision by Elections Cameroon.

CHAPTER IV: SUPERVISION OF POLLS BY THE ELECTORAL BOARD

The Electoral Board's field trip from 4 to 16 March 2023 was essentially focused on supervising the conduct of election operations in polling stations. It enabled Electoral Board Members to visit polling stations in view of witnessing the conduct of voting and vote counting operations.

SECTION I: SUPERVISING VOTING OPERATIONS

The voting exercise and all related operations were supervised by Members of the Electoral Board (MEB). Indeed, in each constituency, they visited polling stations on election day to ensure the effectiveness and regularity of election operations.

Far from being routine, these controls were also part of a continuation of the appeasement mechanism set up beforehand by the Electoral Board. Indeed, they were an opportunity for MEB to resolve possible complaints, on the one hand, and, where appropriate, to recommend solutions to potential problems or difficulties that stakeholders of the process could face throughout the election, on the other hand.

SECTION II: SUPERVISING VOTE COUNTING OPERATIONS

The Electoral Board monitored vote count operations in all the constituencies. Beyond calming minds and removing ambiguities, the objective was to ensure compliance with legal and regulatory provisions on the closure of polling stations and vote counting. Indeed, it was a matter of the Electoral Board, in collaboration with ELECAM's branch officials, ensuring the respect of closing time for polls and the start of counting operations.

Globally, no major incident was reported at the end of these operations, which paved the way for deployment of commissions in charge of vote counting and verification of counting operations.

CHAPTER V: CENTRALISATION AND VOTE COUNTING

Centralising the results of any election consists in gathering them in one spot. Regarding the election of Senators, where voting takes place in divisional headquarters, the centralisation and verification of vote counts took place in the regional capital, which constituted the constituency. A second level of centralisation and verification of the vote counts was conducted at national level by the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes.

It is important to note that for its own purposes, ELECAM set up an internal mechanism to centralise election data.

SECTION I: DEPLOYING AN ELECTION DATA CENTRALISING MECHANISM WITHIN ELECAM

The internal mechanism for centralising election data set up by ELECAM and put in place by the sub-commission for monitoring voting operations and centralising election statistics.

Data collection forms designed for this purpose made it possible to centralise data. In this respect, 10 (ten) monitoring teams were set up, one per region, with the collaboration of local ELECAM officials.

The centralising mechanism was set up in a management centre at the central level composed as follows:

- a technical room (to ensure the proper functioning of the technical infrastructure);

- an analysis room (made up of all the members of the sub-commission);
- a situation room (under the direct supervision of the Director General of Elections in charge of providing solutions identified in the analysis room);
- ten monitoring centres in the regions and;
- 58 (fifty-eight) collectors at the level of polling stations.

This environment was built on a data feedback system using Smart SMS.

The data thus collected was entered into Excel spreadsheets for an automatic calculation of results, pending the counting of votes by regional supervisory commissions and the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes.

SECTION II: COUNTING VOTES

As mentioned in the introductory remarks of this chapter, the counting of votes for the election of Senators is the responsibility of regional supervisory commissions (RSC) and the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes (NCFCV).

At the level of constituencies, 10 (ten) RSC were formed in accordance with legal provisions related to vote counting and verification of vote counting operations.

The work of RSC started as soon as the polls closed. No later than 72 (seventy-two) hours later, each RSC had drawn up its deliberation in

the form of harmonised reports, designed and prepared by ELECAM for each RSC. Chairpersons of the RSC, assisted by ELECAM regional delegates, were responsible for handing over the reports and annexed documents to the NCFCV.

At national level, the NCFCV had 5 (five) days to count the votes and verify the counting operations in the light of these reports and annexed documents forwarded to it by RSC.

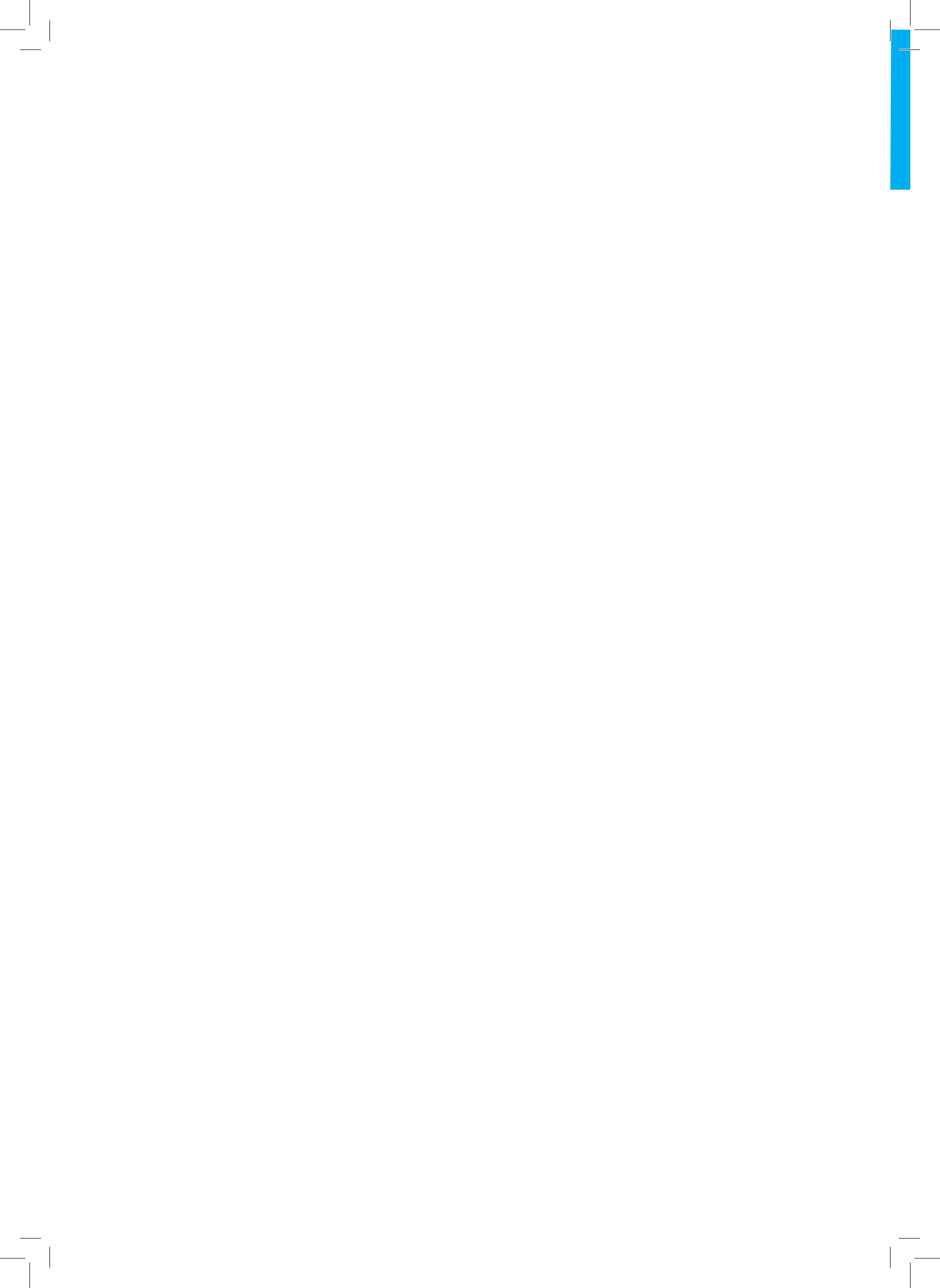
Its work was registered in an election report, also prepared by ELECAM. The NCFCV thus carried out the counting, verification, rectification of reports and compilation of results.

The report of its proceedings, of which each signatory member received a copy, were forwarded to the Constitutional Council, which has the prerogative to proclaim the results after ruling on post-election disputes.

PART IV: POST-ELECTION DISPUTES AND PROCLAMATION OF RESULTS

In accordance with provisions of Section 239 of the Electoral Code, the Constitutional Council ensures the regularity of the election of Senators. As such, it rules on related disputes in accordance with Sections 133 to 136 of the electoral law. It is

also responsible for proclaiming the results of this election (Section 238). The following chapters present the Constitutional Council in the said roles for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators.



CHAPTER I: POST-ELECTION DISPUTES

The conduct of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators was the subject of some disputes. These gave rise to a post-election dispute during which petitioners, questioning the sincerity of the poll, referred the matter to the Constitutional Council, which ruled in a public hearing.

SECTION I: FILING PETITIONS

Three (3) political parties petitioned the Constitutional Council challenging the regularity of the 12 March 2023 poll, namely FDC, SDF and NUDP. These political parties submitted a total of 5 (five) petitions on different grounds.

SECTION II: PUBLIC HEARING FOR SETTLEMENT OF DISPUTES

Public hearing to settle the post-election disputes was held on Tuesday, 24 March 2023, at 11:00 a.m. in the Auditorium of the Constitutional Council. The latter, after having noted the withdrawal of the **SDF**, examined the 4 (four) other petitions filed by **FDC** and **NUDP** (see Annex 13). These petitions were declared admissible in form, but not founded in substance. They were, as a result, all rejected, leaving room for proclamation of the results.

CHAPTER II: PROCLAMATION OF RESULTS

Results of the election of Senators are proclaimed by the Constitutional Council within a maximum of 15 (fifteen) days after the closure of the poll. In this regard, the Constitutional Council held a public hearing at its headquarters on Thursday, 23 March 2023, attended by numerous personalities as well as stakeholders and observers of the electoral process. In doing so, the President of the Constitutional Council read out statistics of the election before releasing the results.

SECTION I: ELECTION STATISTICS

According to statistics of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators,

- 10 (ten) political parties actually took part in the election, namely: the NADP in the Far North, the FDC in the Centre, the CNSF in the North, the MDR in the Far North, the CNRP in

the Littoral, the SDF in the North-West, the CPDM in the 10 (ten) constituencies, the CDU in the West, the UMS in the West and the NUDP in Adamawa, the East, the Far North and the North;

- 11 134 electors were distributed in the 198 polling stations located in the 58 divisional capitals;
- 10 924 electors actually took part in the vote;
- 210 abstentions were recorded;
- The vote count revealed 10 763 valid votes cast and 161 invalid ballots;
- The turnout was 98.11%.

Detailed election statistics per constituency can be found in the table below.

ELECTION STATISTICS PER CONSTITUENCY

REGION	NUM. OF P.S.	REGISTE RED	ABSTENTION	VOTERS	% TURN OUT	INVALID BALLOTS	VVC
ADAMAWA	11	654	1	653	99.85	27	626
CENTRE	37	1 983	8	1 975	99.60	26	1 949
EAST	17	914	3	911	99.67	8	903
FAR NORTH	28	1 566	7	1 559	99.55	35	1 524
LITTORAL	20	1 086	5	1 081	99.54	26	1 055
NORTH	13	760	2	758	99.74	15	743
NORTH-WEST	19	1 127	178	949	84.21	4	945

POST-ELECTION DISPUTES AND PROCLAMATION OF RESULTS

REGION	NUM. OF P.S.	REGISTE RED	ABSTEN TION	VOTERS	% TURN OUT	INVALI D BALLO TS	VVC
WEST	22	1 254	2	1 252	99.84	12	1 240
SOUTH	14	831	2	829	99.76	8	821
SOUTH- WEST	17	959	2	957	99.79	0	957
TOTAL	198	11 134	210	10 924	99,11	161	10 763

SECTION II: RESULTS OF THE ELECTION

On the basis of valid votes cast, the results obtained by each politi-

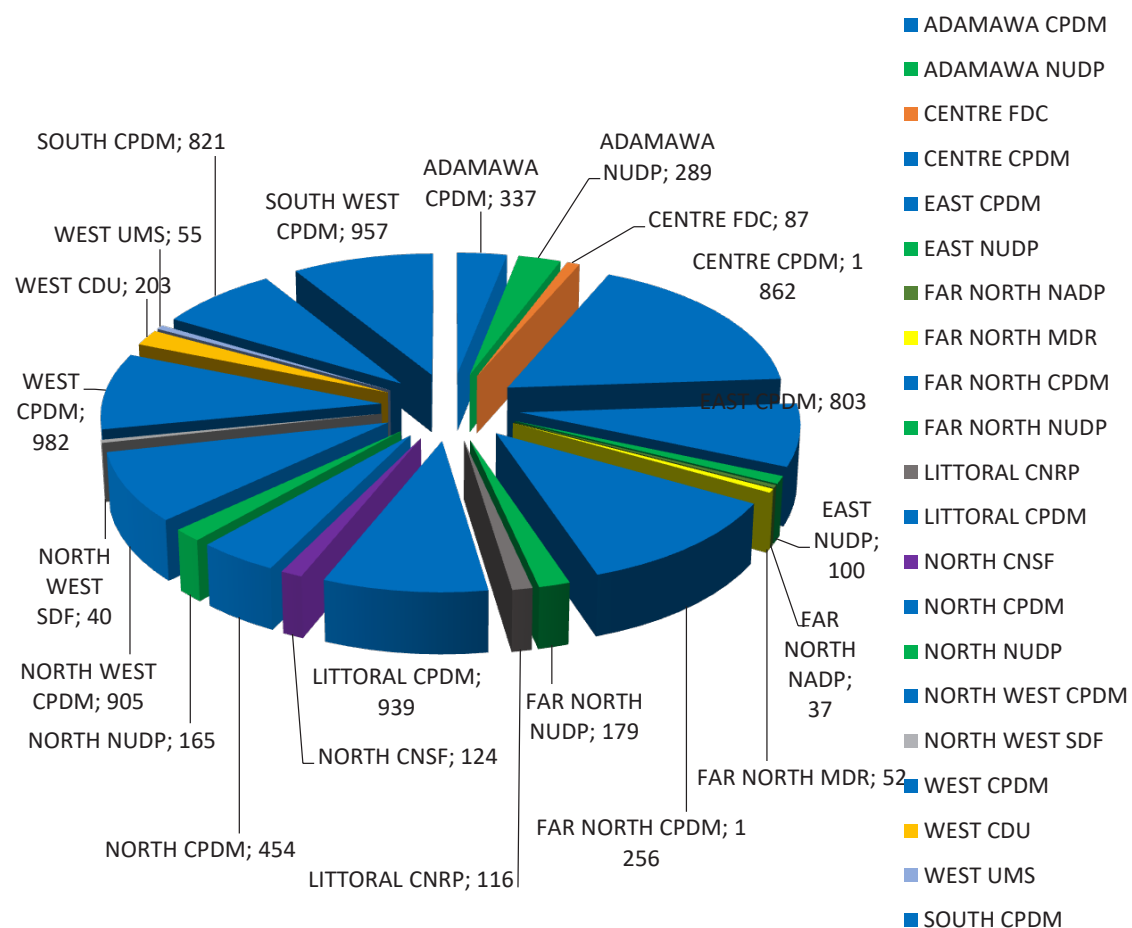
cal party per constituency stand as follows:

RESULTS OBTAINED BY EACH PARTY PER CONSTITUENCY

REGION	POLITICAL PARTY	VOTES CAST	PERCENTAGE (%)
ADAMAWA	CPDM	337	53.3
	NUDP	289	46.7
CENTRE	FDC	87	4.16
	CPDM	1 862	95,54
EAST	CPDM	803	88.3
	NUDP	100	11 07
FAR NORTH	NADP	37	2.43
	MDR	52	3.41
	CPDM	1 256	82.41
	NUDP	179	11.75
LITTORAL	CNRP	116	11
	CPDM	939	89
NORTH	CNSF	124	16.70
	CPDM	454	61,10
	NUDP	165	22.21
NORTH-WEST	CPDM	905	95.77
	SDF	40	4.23

POST-ELECTION DISPUTES AND PROCLAMATION OF RESULTS

REGION	POLITICAL PARTY	VOTES CAST	PERCENTAGE (%)
WEST	CPDM	982	79.19
	CDU	203	16.40
	UMS	55	4.44
SOUTH	CPDM	821	100
SOUTH-WEST	CPDM	957	100



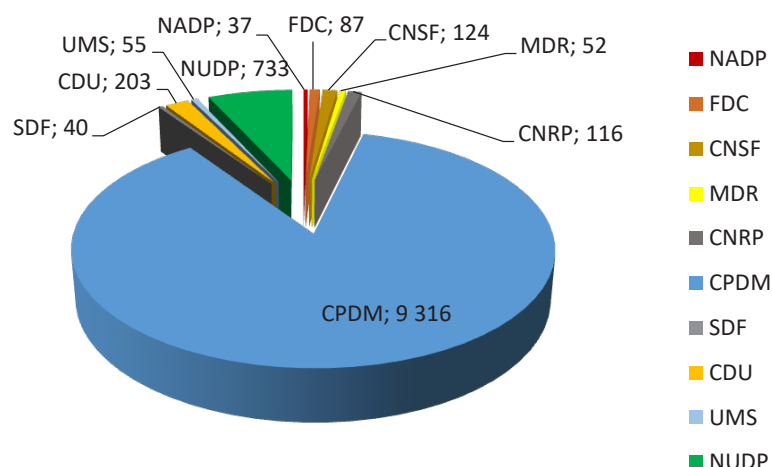
The results obtained by each political party at national level stand as follows:

VALID VOTES CAST BY EACH POLITICAL PARTY AT NATIONAL LEVEL

POLITICAL PARTY	VOTES CAST	PERCENTAGE (%)
NADP	37	0.34
FDC	87	0.81
CNSF	124	1.15
MDR	52	0.48
CNRP	116	1.08
CPDM	9 316	86.56
SDF	40	0.37
CDU	203	1.89

POST-ELECTION DISPUTES AND PROCLAMATION OF RESULTS

POLITICAL PARTY	VOTES CAST	PERCENTAGE (%)
UMS	55	0.51
NUDP	733	6.81
TOTAL	10 763	100



In view of these results, the CPDM won the 70 (seventy) elected seats in competition. None of the other 9 (nine) parties could muster enough votes to win a seat.

Out of the 70 (seventy) elected senators, 28 (twenty-eight), making 40%, are women compared to 22 (twenty-two) for the 2018-2023 legis-

lature, which confirms an increased participation of women in the electoral process. Their distribution per constituency is found the following table:

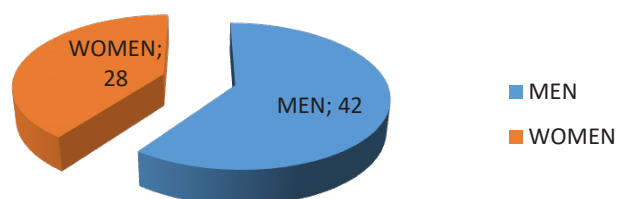
DISTRIBUTION OF THE 70 (SEVENTY) ELECTED SENATORS PER GENDER PER

REGION

REGION	MEN	WOMEN
ADAMAWA	04	03
CENTRE	05	02
EAST	04	03
FAR NORTH	04	03
LITTORAL	04	03
NORTH	04	03
NORTH-WEST	04	03
WEST	04	03
SOUTH	04	03

POST-ELECTION DISPUTES AND PROCLAMATION OF RESULTS

REGION	MEN	WOMEN
SOUTH-WEST	05	02
TOTAL	42	28



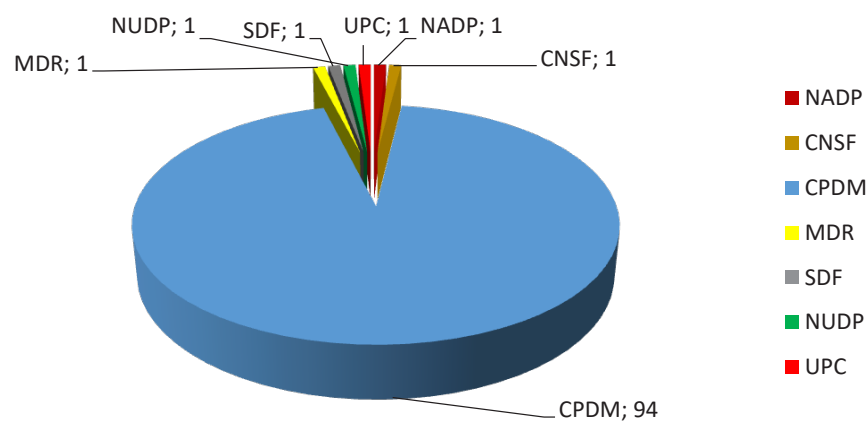
Following proclamation of the election results, the renewal process of the upper house of Parliament was completed with appointment of 30 (thirty) senators by the President of the Republic on 31 March 2023, including 5 (five) women, bringing

the total number of senators to 100 (one hundred), of whom 67 (sixty-seven) are men and 33 (thirty-three) women.

The political set up of the Cameroonian Senate for the third legislature therefore stands as follows:

Political party	Number of Senators
NADP	1
CNSF	1
CPDM	94
MDR	1
SDF	1
NUDP	1
UPC	1
TOTAL	100

POST-ELECTION DISPUTES AND PROCLAMATION OF RESULTS



At another level, it must be observed that the Government Treasury put at the disposal of ELECAM all the funds requested in view of the election of Senators.

PART V: FINANCING OF THE ELECTION

Implementing an electoral process always depends on financial resources. In this regard and as is the custom, Government put at the disposal of ELECAM all the financial resources essential to the material organisation and supervision of the

electoral process in view of renewal of the mandate of Senators. The chapter below describes how these resources were put to use by ELECAM.

CHAPTER I: FINANCING OF THE ELECTION

The 12 March 2023 election of Senators was funded by a budget worth **CFA 6 100 562 500 (six thousand million one hundred million five hundred and sixty-two thousand five hundred Francs)**. It is important to mention that this sum was fully disbursed by the Cameroon Public Treasury.

In terms of resources, these funds were put at the disposal of Elections Cameroon in 5 (five) successive instalments. The pace of these disbursements of funds stands as follows:

- 03 February 2023: 2 000 000 000
- 16 February 2023: 1 000 000 000
- 17 February 2023: 1 000 000 000
- 03 March 2023: 1 000 000 000
- 03 March 2023: 1 100 562 500

This sum allowed for the financing of 3 (three) major activities:

- 1- preparation and material organisation of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators in

the tune of **CFA 3 563 700 000 (three thousand million five hundred and sixty-three million seven hundred thousand) Francs;**

- 2- payment of fees relating to the participation of members of the electoral college and bonuses to ELECAM staff worth **CFA 1 637 462 800 (one thousand million six hundred and thirty-seven million four hundred and sixty-two thousand eight hundred) Francs;**
- 3- activities relating to the supervision and coordination by the Electoral Board in the tune of **CFA 899 400 000 (eight hundred and ninety-nine million four hundred thousand) Francs.**

The statement of expenditure for this budget under these 3 (three) items can be summed up as follows:

No	DESCRIPTION/ITEM	AMOUNT	REMARK
MATERIAL ORGANISATION OF ELECTIONS			
1	Printing: ballot papers, campaign ballots and election documents (voter cards, small and large-size envelopes, decision to lay down and set up the organisation and functioning of polling stations, Electoral Code), Procuring paper and election material	850 500 000	
2	Deploying election material	254 500 000	
3	Logistics and training of regional and divisional officials, divisional local polling commissions and regional supervisory commissions	233 000 000	
4	Laying out an election logistics base at the DGE and in EB for preparation of the polls (packaging and conveyance of election	201 700 000	

FINANCING OF THE ELECTION

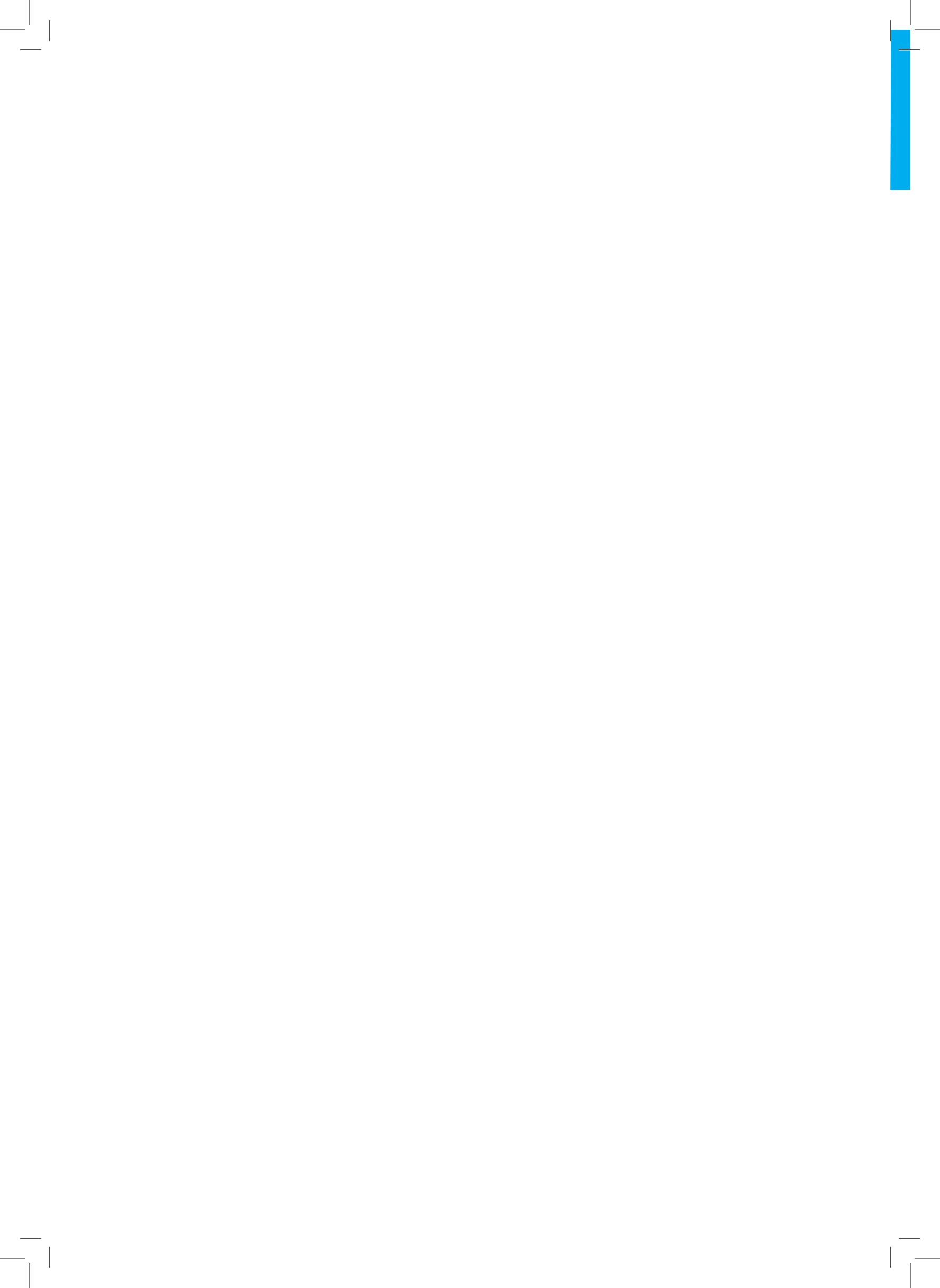
No	DESCRIPTION/ITEM	AMOUNT	REMARK
	material) by sector-specific teams		
5	Communicational activities and consideration of persons with a disability	297 650 000	
6	Improving election biometrics, Procuring hardware, software and consumables for capacity-building at the DGE and Branches	567 000 000	
7	Allowances for special duties in Branches and functioning commissions at the DGE	397 500 000	
8	Servicing rolling stock	279 000 000	
9	Fuel	89 500 000	
10	Running charges for divisional polling commissions during the polls	67 000 000	
11	Running charges for regional supervisory commissions during the polls	83 500 000	
12	Coordination activities for the electoral process	39 500 000	
13	Running charges for commissions in charge of managing candidacy files prior to transmission to the Directorate General of Elections	118 000 000	
14	Allowances for missions to update and consolidate the voters' register for the election of Senators in Divisional Branches	37 500 000	
15	COVID-19 kit for polling stations	47 850 000	
SUB-TOTAL 1		3 563 700 000	
TRANSPORTATION OF ELECTORS AND ELECTION BONUS			
16	Transport allowance for the two electoral colleges	556 900 000	
17	Election bonus (staff bonuses) by merit after the election	1 080 562 500	
SUB-TOTAL 2		1 637 462 500	
COORDINATION BY THE ELECTORAL BOARD			
18	Coordination charges for the Electoral Board	899 400 000	
SUB-TOTAL 3		899 400 000	
GRAND TOTAL		6 100 562 500	

However, it must be acknowledged that the provision of funds is not a solution to all obstacles that arise during management of the electoral process.

PART VI: DIFFICULTIES ENCOUNTERED AND RECOMMENDATIONS

It is not possible to carry out a multidimensional work involving a variety of stakeholders such as an

election without facing obstacles. The 12 March 2023 election of senators was no exception to the rule.



CHAPTER I: DIFFICULTIES ENCOUNTERED

The conduct of the 12 March 2023 electoral process was not without difficulties. Mention can be made, inter alia, of obstacles related to the legal framework and the organisational framework.

- Difficulties related to the legal framework

Lack of precision regarding the form, content and signatory authority of proxies is a source of more or less ambiguous interpretations.

Lack of precision in the deadlines for the proceedings of regional supervisory commissions, as well as in the number of election report copies for local polling commissions and the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes.

- Organisational difficulties

Absence of documents justifying the suspension of voting rights following a criminal conviction or administrative or judiciary custody while proxy voting is allowed for any senatorial elector is unavoidably absent;

Misbehaviour of certain media, which in their coverage of the electoral process disrupt the conduct operations in polling stations.

All these difficulties call for resolutions, hence the formulation of recommendations by the Institution.

CHAPTER II: RECOMMENDATIONS

ELECAM invites all stakeholders of the electoral process, in their respective capacities, to do more towards improving the democratic practice and conduct of the electoral process in Cameroon. Consequently, this body makes the following recommendations to stakeholders of the electoral process:

➤ **Government**

Complete certain provisions of the Electoral Code in view of adapting the legal text to current technological and legislative changes;

➤ **Other stakeholders of the electoral process:**

Encourage synergy in actions, dialogue and sharing of information between all stakeholders of the electoral process for the purpose of affording effective assistance to ELECAM in the conduct of election operations.

➤ **Administration (MINAT, MIN-DEVEL)**

- Sensitise mayors on the imperative need to apply the provisions of Section 91 of the Electoral Code on making space available for the display of election campaign posters and documents;
- Choose neutral areas as campaign venues;

➤ **Political parties**

- Sensitise and educate their militants and sympathisers;

- Take greater account of gender and sociological components when compiling candidate lists;
- Respect the code of best practices.

➤ **Civil society**

- Play its role of raising political awareness and political socialisation among women and youths whose participation in various elections needs to improve.

➤ **Media**

- display greater responsibility, professionalism and equity when using information during media coverage of the electoral process;
- constantly seek for reliable information and consult ELECAM on the conduct expected in polling stations to avoid disturbing deliberations of local polling commissions

Besides taking these recommendations into account, it is necessary to draw lessons from this election.

CONCLUSION

At the end of the electoral process leading to the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, some lessons can be drawn as well as prospects.

From an organisational point of view, the 12 March 2023 election of Senators enabled ELECAM to, once more, confirm its mastery in the organisation of elections, mostly against a backdrop of the insecurity prevailing in more than one constituency. Indeed, polls were conducted in a calm and serene atmosphere, in all the 198 (one hundred and ninety-eight) polling stations, with a voters' register bereft of any anomalies and sufficient quality as well as quantity of election material available in polling stations.

In addition, managing the process for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators showed that all stakeholders played their role to perfection, thus contributing to attain the objective, namely the election of 70 (seventy) senators in all transparency. This is evidenced by the enthusiasm of political parties, the participation of almost all the 11 134 (eleven thousand one hundred and thirty-four) members of the electoral college called to the polls, the effective deployment of electoral commissions and the Constitutional Council, including the positive assessment of certain accredited election observer for the circumstance.

From the socio-political point of view, the 12 March 2023 election contributed in consolidating the democratic culture in Cameroon in the long run. Moreover, it crystallises the hope of seeing local and regional authorities play a more decisive role in taking into account the aspirations of the population for local development. Furthermore, the said election, through the overwhelming victory of the CPDM, crowns the domination of the political arena by this party.

Finally, the presence of 33 (thirty-three) female senators, 28 (twenty-eight) of whom were elected in 2023, increases the representation rate of women in the Senate, from 26% to 33% and constitutes in itself, a significant evolution that reflects the consideration of gender by political parties in compiling candidate lists. This report hopes that this development will continue.

In view of this, the conduct of the electoral process, as a collective endeavour, requires a constant and combined effort of self-improvement on the part of stakeholders, each in its own field of action, to persistently advance the democratic experience in Cameroon.

ELECAM intends to build more trust and credibility in the electoral process, in, the public, by consolidating trust and credibility in the electoral process, as well as continue to of-

fer innovations towards an effective fine-tuning of performances in the material organisation, political and electoral education of electors, and sparking interest and as well improving the Institution's professionalism.

In return, the election management body hopes that each stakeholder in the electoral process will take into account the suggestions and recommendations formulated above. It is true that it is by playing their individual role to perfection that all stakeholders in the electoral process will achieve a better symphony in the conduct of future electoral processes and achieve more outstanding results in the conduct of future election operations.

ANNEXES

ANNEX 1**DECREE No 2023/023 OF 13 JANUARY 2023 TO CONVENE THE ELECTORAL COLLEGE FOR THE ELECTION OF SENATORS**

DECREE No. 2023/023 OF 13 JAN 2023
to convene the electoral colleges for the election of senators

THE PRESIDENT OF THE REPUBLIC,

MINDFUL OF the Constitution;

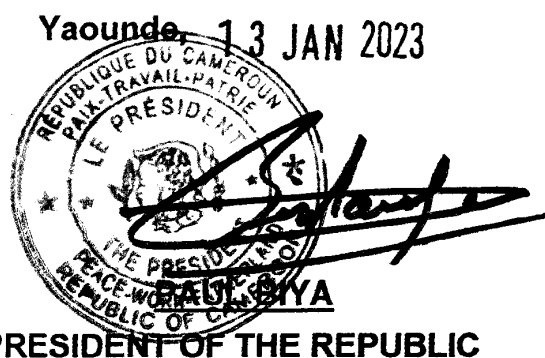
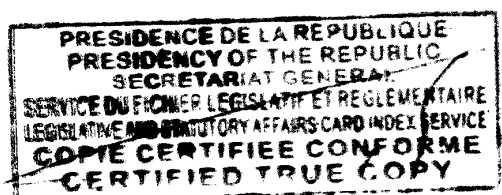
MINDFUL OF Law No. 2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, as amended and supplemented by Law No. 2012/017 of 21 December 2012 and Law No. 2019/005 of 25 April 2019,

HEREBY DECREES AS FOLLOWS:

ARTICLE 1: The electoral college is hereby convened to the chief town of each division on Sunday, 12 March 2023 for the election of senators.

ARTICLE 2: Voting shall begin at 8 a.m. and end at 6 p.m.

ARTICLE 3: This decree shall be registered, published according to the procedure of urgency and inserted in the Official Gazette in English and French.



ANNEX 2**RESOLUTION No 02/R/ELECAM/CE OF 07 FEBRUARY 2023 TO PUBLISH THE LISTS OF CANDIDATES ACCEPTED FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS**

RESOLUTION No 02 / R/ELECAM/CE OF 07 FEB 2023
 to publish the lists of candidates accepted for the 12 March 2023
 election of Senators

THE ELECTORAL BOARD,

Meeting in session as of right on 7 February 2023 in Yaounde,

- Mindful of the Constitution;
- Mindful of Law No.2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, and its subsequent amendments;
- Mindful of Decree No.2018/340 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No.2018/341 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Deputy Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No.2015/475 of 16 September 2019 renewing the term of office of certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No.2019/476 of 16 September 2019 appointing a Member of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2022/297 of 12 July 2022 renewing the term of office of the Chairperson, the Vice-Chairperson and certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2022/298 of 12 July 2022 appointing two Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No. 2023/23 of 13 January 2023 to convene the electoral college for the election of Senators;
- Mindful of Decision No004/D/ELECAM/CEB of 30 January 2023 to set up and lay down the organisation and functioning of a general commission within the Electoral Board in charge of scrutinising and validating nomination papers for the 12 March 2023 election of senators;

and following deliberations;

HEREBY ADOPTS THE RESOLUTION WORDED AS FOLLOWS:

Section 1: (1) A total of 32 (thirty-two) lists of candidatures were presented by 13 (thirteen) political parties for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators.

(2) After careful examination of the candidacy files, 22 (twenty-two) lists of candidates which have fulfilled the conditions set by the electoral law were unanimously accepted by Members of the Electoral Board.

(3) The said lists are presented as follows :



REGIONS		POLITICAL PARTIES	No	SUBSTANTIVES	ALTERNATES
1	ADAMAWA	CPDM	1	OUMAROU ISSA	DAWAIDAI Yvonne
			2	SOUADATOU DJALLO épse KALKABA	SOULEY HAMAYADJI
			3	ROUGAYATOU ASTA DJOULDE	NANA ABDOULAYE
			4	ABBA HAROUNA	AHMADOU TIZANI
			5	BAROUA NYAKEU	FANTA BABA Suzanne
			6	MAMOUDOU MAZADOU	THERESE MOUEN
			7	ZOUBAÏNATOU SALIHOU épse BASSIROU	HAMADAMA HASSAN
		NUDP	1	ADJI Marie Paule	MOHAMADOU ABBO
			2	HALIROU MAMOUDOU	HAMADJOULDE HAMADJAM MOHAMADOU
			3	BABBADA MOCTAR	MEGNANG YAH AUBIN
			4	OUSMANOU SALLE	DIZA GARBA
			5	MOHAMADOU BASCHIROU	AMINATOU Suzane
			6	MAPOH Cécile	AISSATOU MOUSSA
			7	DJAFAROU MOHAMADOU	MADAME épse ENOUA RUTH
2	CENTRE	FDC	1	EKANI OTTOU Godfroy Serge	ZOBO TIDA NDZENG Hélène Flavie
			2	ALIMA Marie Chantal	NDJUBA BARNABAS
			3	NGONO ONDOBO Bienvenu Basile	MINKALA Marie Jeanne
			4	BITCHOBİ BITANG Philippe René	ETA Joseph Emmanuel
			5	ETO'OH Basile	AMEFOMO MBOUKEU Jean Roberto
			6	ANABA MBALLA Xaverie Sidonie	MBUKA Cyprien
			7	ELOUNDOU NGOLO Grégoire	ESSAGA Daniel ZIMPHIRIN
		CPDM	1	NKODO Laurent	MEKONGO ONDOUA Adalbert Séraphin
			2	BELL Luc René	NGO NLOGA épse BIYONG Alice
			3	MAMA Jean-Marie	EYEBE NTI née NGONO Marie Louise
			4	OKALA BILAI Nicole Arlette Eléonore	DJOFLO Denis
			5	KOUNGOU EDIMA Eliane Didier	AWOUMOU BOBO
			6	TABI Pierre Emmanuel	BILOA TSOGO épse EYEBE
			7	BOYOMO ASSALA	YOMBO ISSA AHMED

3	EAST	CPDM	1	AMAMA AMAMA Benjamin	BITOMO EBEYO Gaston Eric
			2	BEGALA MIKEL Naomie épouse AKONO	BELEKOU Gilbert
			3	ASSO Elise	ADJA MINKARANKO Séverine
			4	NDANGA NDINGA Badel	ABENDANG épouse KORONDO
			5	KOTOKO Michel	TAKA MOSSONGOL Thérèse
			6	Mireille ADARE GASSAWILY	SOUMAN NDENGUE Sophine
			7	KOUMA Eugène	OUMAROU MIDJIYAWA
		NUDP	1	ALI DJOULDE	MOHAMADOU BAYERO OUSMAN
			2	DONDJA BAMBOUA Julienne	DANLADI MOUSSA ABDOULAYE
			3	ZONGO AMOUGOU LIN Dieudonné	DJAND David Emmanuel
			4	MOSSOBANDA Célestine	MOHAMADOU ABDALLAH
			5	MAMADOU BALLO	TIDIKE JANVIER
			6	MGBATOKOU Sylvere DIEGUE	ALO'O épouse KEIKEMA Clarisse
			7	MPORO MOISE	BIKOUANEBANDI Faustin
4	FAR NORTH	NADP	1	DIDJA WAZIRI	YOUSSEUFA BOUBA
			2	GARGA MAHNDIA	MOUSTAPHA SAIDOU KATCHALLA
			3	VISSILI TETES	ABDOULAYE MELGUI
			4	ADAMA BOUBA	HADJA BOUKAR
			5	ALIOUM ROUBEN	DERO NGARES GOUTOU
			6	DIPERER CATHERINE	KUVE
			7	VAING PIERRE	HAMADOU BOUBA
		CPDM	1	MAHAMAT ABDOULKARIM	KASSIM OUMAR
			2	ABDOULAYE WOUYAK MARAVA	KOUVOU BOULOUS
			3	ZAKIATOU DJAMO épouse SALE GOUDOUSSOU	WANIE Salomon
			4	ALIOUM ALHADJI HAMADOU	AMADOU
			5	FOUTCHOU Julienne épouse DJAKAOU BOUBA	MARTHE THOMAS
			6	WAIDERE Dorothée Angeline épouse BINGUELA	DJOUPSIA Etienne
			7	NIKAMANE Nathanaël	NANA Séraphine

5	FAR NORTH (suite)	NUDP	1	FENGED ROSE	HALIMATOU
			2	SOULEYMANOU HAMADOU	MOHAMADOU ALHADJI MANA
			3	TAYBE NGABA	MOCKTAR SALI
			4	SIDI OUMAROU	ZIGLA WANDI
			5	ALIOUM HAMAN	KADI ZAKE
			6	MALIKI NGADJIBA	TAPITA épouse DOUBLA
			7	MAHAMAT ELY	LAHDA Thérèse
		MDR	1	DJORWE PAULIN	SAIDOU ALHADJI TOUKOUR
			2	WAMENE KAISSALA	WIWA PAULINE
			3	MOKSIA JACQUES	ALAO ALPHONSE
			4	BOUBAKAR HAMADOU	BREGSALA BONTOING
			5	NGREDEBAI GILBERT	MATAAISSAN GENEVIEVE
			6	ADJI TOUDJANI	BICHARA HALA
			7	MAIHALE LOUISE	BOUBAKARI ABDOULAYE
	LITTORAL	CPDM	1	DIN BELL Marie Armande	BIYAGA KAPYN TEKLA
			2	BILE Jean David	MBONE ESSAMBI Annette Laure
			3	Yvette Josette Jacqueline NG'OBAMA épouse YINDA	NGO MAKELE Elisabeth Liliane
			4	KETCHANGA Célestin	DIPOKO SONGUE Pierre BETANSEDI
			5	MANGA ZANG	HALIMATOU MAHAMODA SANY épouse NJONKOU
			6	Dieudonné DIKABO	KAMSEU
			7	NGANDO NGONDE Marguerite épouse SOPPO SOPPO	OUWE EWANDE Elise
		CPNR	1	KOKO NDOUMBE BEBBE Alice Aimée	MATHIO Régine Jessica
			2	BATOUM Jean Louis	YEBGA Jean Pasteur
			3	DZANGUE TIOMELA Hervé Rostand	TCHOUDJENG MBAMI Luc Yves
			4	NONGWE MAH Daniel	MOUKOUDI MBAPPE Emmanuelle Grace épouse UM NDJOM
			5	KONANGO Julbert	HELL Emmanuel Christy
			6	MOMASO KAPNA Gabriel	Jean Marcel NLOGA
			7	NGO MBELLA Paulette épouse HIMONG	MOO Didier

6	NORTH	FSNC	1	TIZI TOURMBA MALAYE Yves	AÏSSATOU BOUBA épouse SOULEYMANOU
			2	MOUSSA FIRISSOU	AMADOU ISSA MBAMSI
			3	MOUSSA OUMAROU	MINTIDJE Jeannette
			4	AHMADOU ABBO	ALILOU Muller François
			5	RONOU ABOUBAKAR Dieudonné	OUMAROU MAMADOU
			6	YANA Madeleine	ADAMA BETCHE
			7	AMINATOU épouse ABBA	AMBILE Joseph
		CPDM	1	GARBA SOUAÏBOU	MBAINGANG Anastasie Josée
			2	Yvonne ASTA	BOUBA MOUSA
			3	DIDJATOU OUMAROU	WOBADAMASSI ABDOUL-AZIZ
			4	SOUROUHOUL Emmanuel	ZIGOUBE Thérèse
			5	SALAMATOU épouse MOUSSA Martine	ABAKAR MAHAMAT
			6	SALI MOHAMAN	SALIOU YERGUE Elisée
			7	OUMAROU VAIDANG	MAMOUDOU AMADOU BAME
		NUDP	1	MOUSTAPHA IBRAHIMA	BIRWE Grégoire
			2	FESSAYE Marie	DJALAYE SOUNOU
			3	NADJIBER Daniel	AMINATOU OUSMAN
			4	MAIRAMA HAMAN BELLO	FAKAREPTI épouse GAOUSSOUMOU Marie Noelle
			5	OUSMANOU	HABIBA OUMAROU DODO
			6	PASSI Jérôme	ABDOUL KARIM IYA
			7	JOGBA Augustin	ALIOUM HALIDOU
7	NORTHWEST	CPDM	1	LAFON épouse ENO EMMA VERYELE	SHINGWA AMOS MBUH
			2	NGAFEESEN Emmanuel BANTAR	BEMI épouse VOBOH Alice THEBO
			3	NEBA NDOIRI Bridget NDOYE	LUM Juliana NGWA
			4	KOBENGE SEKEDI BOMEH	KAH épouse OKAH Emmerencia MBONG
			5	ENWE Francis ABI	ANTUNKA Mathilda MBWA
			6	FOINTAMA HILDA ALUMA	NUH FUEN Esther
			7	MBUFONG Carl Moses FONTONG	USIMA FATU
		SDF	1	VANIGANSEN MOCHIGGLE	CHI JULIE SWIRI
			2	BUH SULE TEGHA	KETCHEM GLADYS ASHIE
			3	AJUOH NGAM Honoré	TEFU EMMANUEL AWONSANG
			4	KINYANG GEORGES NYANG	NGORAN ABIBA KINYUY
			5	AMBOUFEI DIANA ENGENEMBE	TERBERIA PAUL AMBUE
			6	BUNYUI EMMANUEL NYUGAB	SHEJU CHEMA ALICE EBRICHO
			7	MAFOGHO INUSA PETIANGMA	ISA REKIA NCHIFE

8	WEST	CPDM	1	NGOUCHINGHE Sylvestre	NONO Henri
			2	FOMETHE Anaclet	SEME Régine
			3	MOUTIO Micheline épouse DSAMOU	KOUATCHOU Manfred
			4	POKAM Max	BOUGCHE Constante Clarice épouse KANGANG
			5	TCHUETCHUE MBOKOUOKO Rodrigue	NZAPPA
			6	NGANGOUBE AMINATOU	AHMADOU AHIDJO
			7	PUENE Françoise	MOUTCHEU NOUBISSIE Emmamuel Mathurin
		CDU	1	NJOYA OUMAROU	YANGOYA AMADOU
			2	NKENGNE Anne épouse TCHENDJOU	FADIMATOU GABDO
			3	NGOUTANE Mariama épouse SENDE	WANDOUM Joseph
			4	ADAMOU ARDO YANDI	FOFACK Appolinaire Romain
			5	SONWA Noel	NONO NANWOUA Alain Abraham
			6	MBENKEU Bernard	WANKO Jean
			7	MOMBO Jeanne Belle épouse PETEKO	YOUNSSI KAPAWA Marie Véronique
		UMS	1	NJONKAM Anne	FOMO Martin Michel
			2	TOBO NYALA Ebenezer	TCHAMBA Emmanuel
			3	YOUNDI NGOUETMOUN épouse PAHM RIKIATOU	MANDOU ALIMA Alice
			4	MBOULEFAK Edouard DAMASSE DEMEFO	ESSEZOM
			5	LELE Alain	MAGNE
			6	KOM Norbert	KUATE Joseph
			7	KAMSU Roger	NEMANTOU GENEVIÈVE épouse TIADJEU

9	SOUTH	CPDM	1	ZANG OYONO Calvin	NNA David
			2	MBITA MVAEBEME Lippert Daniel Raymond	METUGU ABENA épouse AKOA
			3	OBAM ASSAM Samuel	MEKINA ASSENG Vincent
			4	ELOUMBA MEDJO Thérèse	SALLA SALLA Vincent
			5	NGBWA BALA Yvette	ZO'O Joseph Séverin
			6	AFANE Jeanne Caroline	FERDINAND EYIZO'O
			7	MBA MBA Grégoire	EYENGA Marie Claire
10	SOUTHWEST	CPDM	1	TABETANDO NDIEB-NSO	ETENGENENG Doris OJONG
			2	OTTE Andrew MOFA	SONA SONA HABIBULLAH
			3	MBELLA MOKI Charles	DORIK MONDE MOKOSSO
			4	NTUBE Agnès NDODE épouse NDJOCK	EKWOGÉ Joseph ELONGOME
			5	ANKIE AFFIONG Rebecca AMAH	NAIENGE MESEMBE Gabriel
			6	LEKUNZE Andreas NEMBO	AMIN MARIANA ANYITOH épouse FONJI
			7	LIONEL PAPINATU FONDERSON	JONG EBENYE Rosine épouse TOTO NDONGUE

Section 2.- This resolution shall be registered and published wherever necessary in English and French./-

Copied to

- V-CEB;
- MEB;
- CONSTITUTIONAL COUNCIL;
- MINAT;
- DGE;
- DDGE;
- RD/ELECAM;
- PUBLIC POSTING;
- CHRONO/ARCHIVES.

Yaounde, the _____

For the Electoral Board,

CHAIRPERSON

ANNEX 3**RESOLUTION No 03/R/ELECAM/CE OF 07 FEBRUARY 2023 TO PUBLISH THE LISTS OF CANDIDATES REJECTED FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS**

RESOLUTION No 03 / R/ELECAM/CE OF 07 FEB 2023

to reject some lists of candidates for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators.-

THE ELECTORAL BOARD,

Meeting in session as of right on 7 February 2023 in Yaounde,

Mindful of the Constitution;

Mindful of Law No.2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, and its subsequent amendments;

Mindful of Decree No.2018/340 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);

Mindful of Decree No.2018/341 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Deputy Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);

Mindful of Decree No.2015/475 of 16 September 2019 renewing the term of office of certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);

Mindful of Decree No.2019/476 of 16 September 2019 appointing a Member of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);

Mindful of Decree No 2022/297 of 12 July 2022 renewing the term of office of the Chairperson, the Vice-Chairperson and certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);

Mindful of Decree No 2022/298 of 12 July 2022 appointing two Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);

Mindful of Decree No. 2023/23 of 13 January 2023 to convene the electoral college for the election of Senators;

Mindful of Decision No 004/D/ELECAM/CEB of 30 January 2023 to set up and lay down the organisation and functioning of a general commission within the Electoral Board in charge of scrutinising and validating nomination papers for the 12 March 2023 election of senators;

and following deliberations;

HEREBY ADOPTS THE RESOLUTION WORDED AS FOLLOWS:

Article 1. - (1) A total of 32 (thirty-two) lists of candidatures were presented by 13 (thirteen) political parties for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators.

(2) After careful examination of the candidacy files, 10 (ten) lists of candidates which have not fulfilled the conditions set by the electoral law were unanimously rejected by Members of the Electoral Board.

(3) The reasons for rejection are as follows:

ADAMAWA REGION**Social Democratic Front (SDF)****Reasons:**

- insufficient number of nomination papers for all the candidates;
- no evidence of payment of deposits for all the candidates;
- lack of certificates of non-conviction (Bulletin No 3) for all the substantive candidates and the alternate candidates Nos 2 and 3;
- no attestation of residence for all the candidates except alternate candidates Nos. 6 and 7;
- lack of certificates of tax solvency for substantive candidates Nos. 5 and 7;
- lack of certificates of tax solvency for all the alternate candidates except alternate No 7;
- no certificate of nationality and copy of birth certificate for alternate candidate No 3.

- **Union of the People of Cameroon (UPC)**

Reasons:

- the authority that endorsed the list for the political party had no legal competence to do so (*Supreme Court/C.A judgment of 12 October 2022*);
- no attestation of residence for all the candidates;
- no evidence of payment of deposits for all the candidates;
- lack of attestation of voter registration for all the candidates except the substantive candidates No 1 and 3.

II- CENTRE REGION

- **Cameroon Democratic Youth (JDC)**

Reasons:

- nomination papers joined, not signed and not legalised for all the candidates;
- no evidence of payment of deposits for all the candidates;
- lack of certificate of non-conviction (Bulletin No 3) for all the candidates;

- **Cameroon Union for Democracy and Innovation (UCDI)**

Reasons:

- lack of certificates of tax solvency for all the candidates;
- no evidence of payment of deposits for all the candidates;
- lack of certificate of non-conviction (Bulletin No 3) for all the candidates;
- except for the attestation of nomination, the files of alternate candidates No 2, 4 and 5 contain no documents;

- **Union of the People of Cameroon (UPC)**

Reasons:

- the authority that endorsed the list for the political party had no legal competence to do so (*Supreme Court/C.A judgment of 12 October 2022*);
- no evidence of payment of deposits for all the candidates;
- lack of certificates of tax solvency for substantive candidates No 1 and 2.

LITTORAL REGION

■ Union of the People of Cameroon (UPC)

Reasons:

- presentation of two lists of candidatures by the same political party;
- lack of nomination papers for substantive candidates No 3 and 4, and alternate candidates No 1, 3, 4, 5 and 6;
- insufficient number of nomination papers for substantive candidates Nos. 2, 5 and 7; and alternate candidates Nos. 2 and 7;
- the authority that endorsed one of the lists for the political party had no legal competence to do so (*Supreme Court/C.A judgment of 12 October 2022*) ;
- no evidence of payment of deposits for all the candidates.

IV- NORTH-WEST REGION

■ Union of the People of Cameroon (UPC)

Reasons:

- the authority that endorsed the list of the party had no legal competence (*Supreme Court/C.A judgment of 12 October 2022*);
- no certificates of tax solvency for all the candidates;
- no evidence of payment of deposits for all the candidates;
- no copy of birth certificate for all the substantive candidates except the alternate candidates Nos 3, 5 and 6;
- discrepancies in the dates of birth of substantive candidate No 7;
- no nomination paper for alternate candidate No 7;
- lack of legal age for alternate candidates No. 4 born on 3/8/1990 (32 years) and No.7 born on 23/7/1989 (33 years).

V- WEST REGION

■ Union of the People of Cameroon (UPC)

Reasons:

- presentation of two lists of candidatures by the same political party;
- no constituent documents for all the alternate candidates;
- no evidence of payment of deposits for all the candidates;
- incomplete nomination papers for all the substantive candidates;
- candidate TICHEMBIAP FEKOUA Elie is present on 02 different lists both as substantive and alternate.

Article 2.- The Director General of Elections shall immediately notify this resolution to the political parties concerned.

Article 3.- This resolution shall be registered and published wherever necessary in English and French./.

Copied to

- V- CEB;
- MEB;
- Constitutional Council;
- MINAT;
- DGE;
- DDGE;
- RD/ELECAM;
- PUBLIC POSTING;
- CHRONO/ARCHIVES.

Yaounde, the _____

For the Electoral Board,

CHAIRPERSON

ANNEX 4

**RESOLUTION No 004/R/ELECAM/CE OF 23 FEBRUARY 2023 TO ESTABLISH
COMPOSITION OF THE NATIONAL COMMISSION FOR THE FINAL COUNTING OF VOTES
FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS**

RESOLUTION No - 004 /R/ELECAM/EB OF 23 FEB 2023

**to establish the composition of National Commission for the Final Counting of
Votes in view of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators.-**

THE ELECTORAL BOARD,

Meeting in session as of right on 23 February 2023 in Yaounde,

- Mindful of the Constitution;
- Mindful of Law No 2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, and its subsequent amendments;
- Mindful of Decree No 2018/340 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2018/341 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Deputy Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2019/475 of 16 September 2019 renewing the term of office of certain members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2019/476 of 16 September 2019 appointing a member of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2022/297 of 12 July 2022 renewing the term of office of the Chairperson, the Vice-Chairperson and certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2022/298 of 12 July 2022 appointing certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2023/23 of 13 January 2023 to convene the Electoral College for the election of Senators;
- Mindful of Resolution No 002/R/ELECAM/EB of 7 February 2023 to publish the lists of candidates accepted for the election of Senators on 12 March 2023;

And after deliberations;

ADOPTED THE RESOLUTION WORDED AS FOLLOWS:

Section 1. - As of the date of adoption of this Resolution, the composition of the **National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes** in view of the election of Senators on 12 March 2023, shall be established as follows:

- **Chairperson:** ESSOMBE Emile
- **Members:**
 - **Representatives of the Judiciary**
 - 1- FONKWE JOSEPH FONGANG
 - 2- ONDOUA OBOUNOU CHARLES
 - **Representatives of the Administration**
 - 1- NGANKO FIRMIN DANIEL
 - 2- PEKASSA NDAM GERARD MARTIN
 - 3- BEKILA GISELE VALERIE
 - 4- ISSANDA ISSANDA ALAIN SALOMON
 - 5- AMADOU SOULEY

- **Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)**
 - 1- ABDOULKARIMOU
 - 2- ENOW DICKSON ENOW
 - 3- MISSE EPOUNDE ARMAND
 - 4- NNOMO née MINLANG CHRISTELLE IRIS LEOPOLDINE
 - 5- ESSI née NDZENGUE NGOAH MICHELE ARLETTE
- **Representatives of political parties**
 - 1- AGBOR ASAH ELISUS (ANDP)
 - 2- DENIS EMILIEN ATANGANA (FDC)
 - 3- NSOGA épouse SONE EKOLO JEANNE (FSNC)
 - 4- Me DJORWE PAULIN (MDR)
 - 5- NYECK BIYAGA JOSEPH FELIX (PCRN)
 - 6- TALBA MALLA IBRAHIM (RDPC)
 - 7- Barrister BONIFACE MBAH NDAM (SDF)
 - 8- MONGWAT AMADOU (UDC)
 - 9- KOUEMO JOSEPH (UMS)
 - 10- PIERRE FLAMBEAU NGAYAP (UNDP)

Section 2. - The political party whose representative does not appear on this resolution shall, prior to the commencement of deliberations, submit to the Chairperson of the National Commission for the Final Counting of Votes the original of the duly signed appointment document. A copy shall be immediately transmitted to the Electoral Board.

Section 3. - This resolution shall be registered and published wherever necessary in English and French./-

Copied to:

- V/CEB;
- MEB;
- CONSTITUTIONAL COUNCIL;
- SUPREME COURT;
- MINAT;
- DGE;
- DDGE;
- THE CONCERNED;
- PUBLIC POSTING;
- CHRONO/ARCHIVES.

Yaounde, the 23 FEB 2023

For the Electoral Board,

Chairperson

ANNEX 5**RESOLUTION No 005/R/ELECAM/CE OF 03 MARCH 2023 TO REPLACE A SUBSTANTIVE CANDIDATE IN THE SOUTH-WEST CONSTITUENCY FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS.*****THE ELECTORAL BOARD,******Meeting in extraordinary session on 3 March 2023 in Yaounde,***

- Mindful of the Constitution;
- Mindful of Law No 2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, and its subsequent amendments;
- Mindful of Decree No 2018/340 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2018/341 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Deputy Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2019/475 of 16 September 2019 renewing the term of office of certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2019/476 of 16 September 2019 appointing a member of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2022/297 of 12 July 2022 renewing the term of office of the Chairperson, the Vice-Chairperson and certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2022/298 of 12 July 2022 appointing certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
- Mindful of Decree No 2023/23 of 13 January 2023 to convene the Electoral College for the election of Senators;
- Mindful of Decision No 004/D/ELECAM/CEB of 30 January 2023 to set up and lay down the organisation and functioning of a general commission within the Electoral Board in charge of scrutinising and validating nomination papers for the 12 March 2023 election of senators;
- Mindful of Resolution No 002/R/ELECAM/EB of 7 February 2023 to publish the lists of candidates accepted for the election of Senators on 12 March 2023;

And following deliberations;**HEREBY UNANIMOUSLY ADOPTS THE RESOLUTION WORDED AS FOLLOWS:**

Section 1.- In view of the 12 March 2023 election of Senators, one substantive candidate in the South-West constituency shall be replaced on the list of candidates accepted by the Electoral Board, as follows:

SOUTHWEST REGION :**➤ Political party: CPDM**

- Mrs. **MOSONGO Ernestine AKON NJONG** in replacement of Mrs. **ANKIE AFFIONG Rebecca AMAH**, deceased.

Section 2.- This decision shall be registered and published wherever necessary in English and French./-

Copied to

- V-CEB;
- MEB;
- CONSTITUTIONAL COUNCIL;
- MINAT;
- DGE;
- DDGE;
- RD/ELECAM;
- PUBLIC POSTING;
- CHRONO/ARCHIVES.

Yaounde, the 3rd March 2023

Chairperson of the Electoral Board

ANNEX 6

**DECISION No 009/D/ELECAM/PCE OF 03 MARCH 2023 OF THE ELECTORAL BOARD
TO ESTABLISH COMPOSITION OF REGIONAL SUPERVISORY COMMISSIONS FOR THE 12
MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS**

The Chairperson of the Electoral Board,

Mindful of the Constitution;
 Mindful of Law No 2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, and its subsequent amendments;
 Mindful of Decree No 2018/340 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
 Mindful of Decree No 2018/341 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Deputy Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
 Mindful of Decree No 2019/475 of 16 September 2019 renewing the term of office of certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
 Mindful of Decree No 2019/476 of 16 September 2019 appointing a member of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
 Mindful of Decree No 2022/297 of 12 July 2022 renewing the term of office of the Chairperson, the Vice-Chairperson and certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
 Mindful of Decree No 2022/298 of 12 July 2022 appointing certain Members of the Electoral Board of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM);
 Mindful of Decree No 2023/23 of 13 January 2023 to convene the Electoral College for the election of Senators;
 Mindful of Resolution No 002/R/ELECAM/EB of 7 February 2023 to publish the lists of candidates accepted for the election of Senators on 12 March 2023;

Considering service requirements;

HEREBY DECIDES AS FOLLOWS:

Section 1. - As of the date of signature of this decision, the composition of **Regional Supervisory Commissions** in view of the election of Senators on 12 March 2023, shall be established as follows:

I- ADAMAWA REGION

- Chairperson: ANDRE MARIE MBA
- Representatives of the Administration
 - ABOUMA BILOA CHRISTIAN JOSEPH
 - BOBAIBOURNONE NATHAN
 - AMADOU BELLO
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - OUMAROU AMADOU
 - NANA DJILY STEPHANIE NOELLE
 - YOUSOUFA FADIMATOU
- Representatives of political parties
 - BAORO THEOPHILE (CPDM)
 - BOBBO SALIHOU (NUDP)

II- CENTRE REGION

- Chairperson: EMGBANG ONDOA RENE FLORENTIN
- Representatives of the Administration
 - NKE ONGUENE MARIE MADELEINE Epse NKOULOU
 - EYEBE EYEBE ANDRE JOSEPH
 - MANI LEONARD
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - MODJO KAMDEM ARNOLD
 - ABOUBAKAR MOHAMAN
 - AMAH NDZANA COME
- Representatives of political parties
 - DENIS EMILIEN ATANGANA (CDF)
 - ELOMO NTONGA LISETTE (CPDM)

III- EAST REGION

- Chairperson: NGANSO JEAN
- Representatives of the Administration
 - NGOAN KELE ARLETTE CLOTILDE
 - ENDOM ASSENGUE SALOMON
 - MEBOUA MADJER BEGUINE
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - DAMDJA ELYSE CYRILLE
 - AYANGMA MANGA FLORENT BARTHELEMY
 - NKAH BETSEM JEAN BAPTISTE
- Representatives of political parties
 - DIMBELE SODEA JEAN-MARIE (CPDM)
 - ADAMOU ABDON (NUDP)

IV- FAR NORTH REGION

- Chairperson: AOUDOU FRANCOIS
- Representatives of the Administration
 - BANDIBENO WILLIAM
 - FOSSOUO ANDRE
 - BINYE NDJEE BORIS PARFAIT
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - MOLUH JULES EMILE
 - HAMADOU SADJO
 - MOHAMADOU MANSOUR BACHIR
- Representatives of political parties
 - BOBBO MOUSSA SARSAR (NADP)
 - KAMGAING SITAMZE DJOKO BERTRAND (MDR)
 - BAKARI ROBERT (CPDM)
 - NDJIDDA BAKARI (NUDP)

V- LITTORAL REGION

- Chairperson: BILLONG JULES RAYMOND
- Representatives of the Administration
 - ABOUBAKARY HAMAN TCHIOUTO
 - ZENABOU MALI épouse BAKARY
 - BAYIHA épouse TCHOUAWOU FRANÇOISE CHAVELI
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - OTYA'A BOURDON SERGE
 - NDJOCK JAMES BILLY IDOLL
 - NTEPPE JEMBE CHARLES
- Representatives of political parties
 - CHRISTIAN NDJOCK NKONGO (CPNR)
 - MBASSA NDINE ROGER VICTOR (CPDM)

VI- NORTH REGION

- Chairperson: ONANA MICHEL JEAN CLAUDE
- Representatives of the Administration
 - AVOM DANG
 - ALIM GARGA
 - NANG BRICE ROBERT
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - MBOND ABDUL AZIZ
 - SOUA née FIDA FELICITE
 - HAYATOU
- Representatives of political parties
 - AMADOU ISSA MBAMSI (CNSF)
 - BAYERO BOUNOU (CPDM)
 - MOUSTAPHA IBRAHIMA (NUDP)

VII- NORTH-WEST REGION

- Chairperson: SOKEM NGALE MBORH
- Representatives of the Administration
 - BASSILEKIN GEORGES EMMANUEL MAGLOIRE
 - SAIDOU MUSSA
 - KENFACK FABIEN
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - FONKANYUY JUDE THADEAUS
 - ZOFOA NJOYA SAKÉ
 - AMBUFEI ESTHER
- Representatives of political parties
 - FAI YENGO FRANCIS (CPDM)
 - EZEKIEL NJI CHI (SDF)

VIII- WEST REGION

- Chairperson: ONDOUA HORTENSE
- Representatives of the Administration
 - EPENTE TAZEU ADRAY
 - PATRICK SUH NDELE
 - JOEL BADENA
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - ABDOURAHMAN
 - ABDOULLAHI BOBOE
 - KADJE DEPE GABIN
- Representatives of political parties
 - NGAMBO FONDJO PIERRE VINCENT (CPDM)
 - MFOPOU ABOUBAKAR (CDU)
 - NJONKAM ANNE (UMS)

IX- SOUTH REGION

- Chairperson: WANSI VICTOR MIRABEAU
- Representatives of the Administration
 - NDJANA CLOTHILDE épouse NSOH
 - ESSOMBA ONKOANT ARTHUR RAOUL
 - BOOG JEAN CALVIN JUNIOR
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - EBOA DINDE GUY MAURICE
 - KWA DICKA EMMANUEL
 - BELINGA NNANG JEAN MICHEL
- Representatives of political parties
 - ZE MEKA REMY (CPDM)

X- SOUTH-WEST REGION

- Chairperson: AGBOR JAMES EYONG
- Representatives of the Administration
 - ELEPI EWANE JACQUES
 - NJUKANG FONJU BERNARD
 - AGBOR TEDDY NGECK
- Representatives of Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)
 - MUKETE GUSTAVE
 - MEWANU DIVINE MOKOTO
 - MEREKE ETU JACQUELINE NBONDE
- Representatives of political parties
 - NGONI NJIE FRANKLIN (CPDM)

Section 2. - This decision, which repeals all previous provisions, shall be registered and published wherever necessary in English and French./-

Copied to:

- V/CEB;
- MEB;
- DGE;
- DDGE;
- GOVERNORS;
- PRESIDENT OF COURTS OF APPEAL;
- THE CONCERNED;
- PUBLIC POSTING;
- CHRONOS/ARCHIVES.

Yaounde, the

For the Electoral Board,

Chairperson

ANNEX 7**DECISION No 000018 /D/ ELECAM/ DGE OF 10 FEBRUARY 2023 TO DETERMINE THE MAXIMUM SIZE OF POSTERS FOR THE ELECTORAL CAMPAIGN AND PUBLICATION OF CAMPAIGN MATERIAL FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS**

000018
DECISION No. 000018 /D/ELECAM/DGE OF 10 FEB 2023 to
 determine the maximum size of posters for the election campaign and
 procedure for the publication of campaign documents for the 12 March
 2023 election of Senators

THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF ELECTIONS,

Mindful of the Constitution;

Mindful of Law No.2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, amended and supplemented by Laws No.2012/017 of 21 December 2012 and 2019/005 of 25 April 2019;

Mindful of Decree No.2018/340 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Director General of Elections at Elections Cameroon;

Mindful of Decree No. 2023/023 of 13 January 2023 to convene the electoral college for the election of senators;

HEREBY DECIDES AS FOLLOWS:

Article 1: - (1) The maximum size of posters for the election campaign for the 12 March 2023 election of senators shall be **600 x 400 centimetres**.

(2) Election campaign posters for each list of candidates shall be produced at their expense, on a paper having the same colour as the one chosen for the printing of campaign and ballot papers.

Article 2: (1) Pursuant to the provisions of **Section 89 of the law relating to the Electoral Code**, such circulars, manifestoes and posters of list of candidates shall be submitted in duplicate to Elections Cameroon for prior endorsement before publication.

(2) The printed document shall make mention of such endorsement.

Article 3: The said endorsement shall be withheld where a document is tantamount to a call to violence or undermines national territorial integrity, the Republican form of the State, State sovereignty, national unity or incites hatred against a State official or a citizen or a body of citizens.

Article 4: Any document published and circulated in contravention of legal provisions or those of this decision shall be seized by the Administrative Authorities, at the request of Elections Cameroon branches without prejudice to such criminal prosecution as may be instituted against the authors of such documents and the disseminators thereof.

Article 5: In conformity with **Section 91 of the Electoral Code**, council authorities shall make available appropriate space for the posting of campaign material.

Article 6: The circulation of campaign ballots, articles and campaign material as well as the wearing of party uniforms or gadgets of a political party in a polling station, shall be forbidden on Election Day.

Article 7: This decision shall be registered and published wherever necessary. /-

Copied to

- Constitutional Council;
- Chairperson/ELECAM ;
- MINAT;
- ELECAM branches;
- The Media (Wide broadcast)
- Public notice
- Chrono/Archives.

Yaounde, on 10 FEB 2023



ESSOUSSE Erik
DIRECTOR GENERAL OF ELECTIONS,

ANNEX 8**DECISION No 000019/D/ ELECAM/ DGE OF 10 FEBRUARY 2023 TO DETERMINE THE SIZE OF BALLOT PAPERS AND CAMPAIGN BALLOTS FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS**

000019
 DECISION No. _____ D/ELECAM/DGE OF 10 FEB 2023
 to determine the size of ballot papers and campaign ballots for the
 12 March 2023 election of Senators

THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF ELECTIONS,

Mindful of the Constitution;
 Mindful of Law No.2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, amended and supplemented by
 Laws No.2012/017 of 21 December 2012 and 2019/005 of 25 April 2019;
 Mindful of Decree No.2018/340 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Director General of Elections at Elections
 Cameroon;
 Mindful of Decree No. 2023/023 of 13 January 2023 to convene the electoral college for the election of
 Senators;
 Considering the assent of the Electoral Board,

HEREBY DECIDES AS FOLLOWS:

Section 1. – The size of ballot papers and campaign ballots for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators shall be as follows:

(1) Ballot paper

The ballot paper shall be 150 x 100 millimetres. It shall be printed on paper weighing between 60 and 90 grams per square metre.

It shall be the same colour as that chosen by the political party in the nomination paper and shall bear inscriptions concerning the political party including the list of candidates, logo or acronym on the front side.

The said ballot shall also bear the phrases, "Republic of Cameroon", "2023 Election of Senators" in English and French.

The back of the said ballot shall be blank.

(2) Campaign ballot

The campaign ballot shall be a sample of the ballot paper and shall be marked, "Campaign ballot" in English and "*Bulletin de campagne*" in French.

Section 2. In view of the election campaign, the Directorate General of Elections shall make campaign ballots available to each list of candidates.

Section 3. - This decision shall be registered and published wherever necessary. /.

Copied to

- Constitutional Council;
- Chairperson/ELECAM ;
- MINAT;
- ELECAM branches;
- The Media (Wide broadcast)
- Public notice
- Chrono/Archives.

Yaounde, on 10 FEB 2023


ESSOUSSE Erik
 DIRECTOR GENERAL OF ELECTIONS

ANNEXE 9**DECISION No 000028/D/ ELECAM/ DGE OF 17 FEBRUARY 2023 TO LAY DOWN AND SET UP THE ORGANISATION AND FUNCTIONING OF POLLING STATIONS FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS****DECISION No. _____/D/ELECAM/DGE OF _____
to lay down and set up the organisation and functioning of polling
stations for the 12 March 2023 election of senators****THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF ELECTIONS,**

Mindful of the Constitution;

Mindful of Law No.2012/001 of 19 April 2012 relating to the Electoral Code, amended and supplemented by Laws No.2012/017 of 21 December 2012 and 2019/005 of 25 April 2019;

Mindful of Decree No.2018/340 of 28 May 2018 appointing the Director General of Elections Cameroon;

Mindful of Decree No. 2023/023 of 13 January 2023 to convene the electoral college for the election of Senators;

Considering service requirements,

HEREBY DECIDES AS FOLLOWS:**CHAPTER I****GENERAL PROVISIONS**

Article 1. - This decision lays down and sets up the organisation and functioning of polling stations for the 12 March 2023 election of Senators.

Article 2. - Activities shall be carried out in every polling station in strict compliance with provisions of the Electoral Code and COVID-19 preventive measures (systematic washing of hands, mandatory wearing of a face mask, social distancing) prescribed by Government. These shall involve activities preceding voting, voting itself and vote counting.

CHAPTER II**ACTIVITIES PRECEDING VOTING****SECTION I****ELECTION MATERIAL AND DOCUMENTS**

Article 3. - (1) Each polling station shall be furnished with the following election material and documents:

- 1 (one) ballot box;
- 1 (one) polling booth;
- Seals;
- 1 (one) disposal bag;
- 1 (one) stamp pad and indelible ink;
- 1 (one) date stamp;
- Pens;
- 1 (one) calculator;
- 1 (one) lamp;
- 1 (one) ELECAM fabric;
- 2 (two) copies of the list of senatorial electors;
- 1 (one) copy of the decision to lay down and set up the organisation and functioning of polling stations;
- 1 (one) copy of Local Polling Commission Chairperson and Members' Guide;
- Ballot papers of each political party or list of candidates running for the election;
- Election return report forms;
- Counting sheets;
- Appropriate envelopes;
- Stationery;

(2) The election material and documents listed under Paragraph (1) above, excluding the polling booth, disposal bag and ballot boxes, shall be placed on the table(s) where members of the local polling commission are sitting.

(3) Ballot boxes shall be placed in the middle of the hall, in front of the table(s) where members of the local polling commission are sitting.

(4) The polling booth shall be placed inside the polling station, in full view of electors. It must be placed such as to allow each elector to cast his/her vote in secrecy.

(5) The disposal bag shall be placed inside the polling booth. Each elector shall be expected to throw all the ballot papers he/she has not chosen in the said bag.

SECTION II**OPENING THE POLLING STATION AND COMMENCEMENT OF VOTING**

Article 4. - (1) The local polling commission chairperson and members must lay out the election material and documents listed under Article 3 above in the polling station before voting begins.

(2) The polls must and shall effectively open at 8 am prompt.

Article 5. - (1) Before getting set for the first vote to be cast, the local polling commission chairperson must open the ballot box, in order to allow all members of the local polling commission and, where appropriate, duly accredited national and international observers as well as electors present, to confirm that it is empty and have only one opening designed for slotting in envelopes.

(2) The local polling commission chairperson must then close the ballot box again and seal it, under the watchful eyes of the persons mentioned under Paragraph (1) above.

CHAPTER III:**CONDUCT OF VOTING OPERATIONS****SECTION I****ACCOMPLISHMENT OF THE VOTING EXERCISE**

Article 6. - (1) Before entering the polling station, each elector must wash his/her hands with soap or hand sanitizer, wear his/her face mask and keep a social distance of at least 1 (one) metre all the way through the voting exercise.

(2) Before casting his/her vote, each elector, bearer of his/her national identity card and voter's card, must be identified by the local polling commission as prescribed by the established rules and conventions.

(3) Once identified, the elector must, without help, pick up one ballot paper of each political party or list of candidates as well as one envelope, under the watchful eyes of the local polling commission chairperson and members.

(4) After collecting the election documents mentioned under Paragraph (3) above, the elector must enter the polling station, select the ballot paper of his/her choice, put it in the envelope. He/she then throws the rest into the disposal bag placed inside the polling station.

(5) The elector must come out of the polling station with the envelope containing the ballot paper that he/she has chosen and slots it into the ballot box.

Article 7. - (1) The vote of the elector must be then evidenced by affixing his/her signature beside his/her name on the polling station electoral register, within the column provided for that purpose and affixing his/her thumbprint, marked with indelible ink.

(2) If the elector is unable to sign, his/her vote must be evidenced by affixing his/her fingerprint, marked with indelible ink, on the polling station electoral register.

(3) After completing the voting exercise, the elector must collect his/her voter's card and/or national identity and leave the polling station right away.

(4) Once the elector's vote is actually cast and completed, the elector shall be paid the prescribed fee for participating in the vote.

Article 8. – Any elector, duly enrolled on the polling station electoral register and not in possession of his/her voter's card must be allowed to vote, upon presentation of his/her national identity card to the local polling commission.

Article 9. - (1) Any person who is unable to accomplish the voting exercise described under Article 6 above, without help, may enlist the assistance of an elector of his/her choice, provided such elector is enrolled on the polling station electoral register concerned.

(2) The elector enlisted in this regard, described under Paragraph (1) above, must neither be a candidate nor the representative of a list of candidates. This same elector must not be allowed to assist more than one person.

(3) An elector may be allowed to vote in place of another elector if the latter is unable to vote and has given the former a valid proxy.

The proxy may be used only once and shall be given to the chairperson of the local polling commission who shall attach it to the report of the proceedings. No voter may hold more than one proxy.

Article 10. - The local polling commission chairperson must take appropriate measures, to facilitate entry into the polling station and voting for persons with a disability, pregnant women and elderly persons who turn out to exercise their voting right.

SECTION II

ROLE OF THE LOCAL POLLING COMMISSION CHAIRPERSON

Article 11. - The local polling commission chairperson must ensure a smooth conduct of polls in the polling station.

In this regard he/she must,

- make sure that election material and documents are available;
- maintain law and order;
- make sure that at least 3 (three) members of the commission are always present inside the polling station for the duration of the polling operations;
- avoid leaving the polling station for the duration of the polls;
- ensure that election documents are filled correctly and forward them to their legal recipients.

Article 12. - (1) Only the chairperson and members of the local polling commission shall be allowed to stay in the polling station for the duration of the polls.

(2) Any person not enrolled on the polling station electoral register concerned must be expelled by the local polling commission chairperson, excluding the candidates or their representatives, administrative unit heads or their representatives and branch officials of Elections Cameroon, provided they do not disrupt the conduct of polls.

(3) Any parking or overcrowding in front of the polling station shall be forbidden. The chairperson of the local polling commission must ensure the respect of these guidelines.

(4) In case of overcrowding inside or in front of the polling station, the chairperson of the local polling commission may requisition the forces of law and order to restore order or cause the polling station to be vacated.

Article 13. - (1) Carrying of any apparent weapon and any harmful object into the polling station shall be strictly forbidden

(2) It shall be strictly forbidden to hurl threats at electors or members of the local polling commission.

(3) Any removal or displacement of the ballot box or any other election material by an elector shall be formally prohibited.

(4) The chairperson of the local polling commission must ensure that the provisions of this Article are respected. In that regard, he/she must cause the expulsion from the polling station of any author of these acts. Where necessity, he/she may requisition the forces of law and order.

Article 14. - (1) At 6 pm prompt, the Chairperson of the Local Polling Commission must declare the poll closed.

(2) However, electors already present inside the hall at the closing hour, as well as those waiting outside the door to enter the hall, must be allowed to cast their votes.

(3) After the poll is declared closed, the polling station must remain open for the vote counting exercise.

(4) The chairperson of the local polling commission must take necessary measures to prepare the hall for the vote counting operations.

CHAPTER IV

VOTE COUNTING PROCEDURE

Article 15. - (1) The vote-counting exercise shall be conducted by the local polling commission.

(2) Prior to the vote counting exercise, the chairperson of the local polling commission must appoint scrutineers and enter their names in the vote counting sheets. Moreover, he shall prepare the counting sheets.

Article 16. - (1) At the end of the polling exercise, any elector who wishes to attend the vote counting shall be allowed to enter the hall, provided the hall can contain them without disrupting the exercise.

(2) The Chairperson of the Local Polling Commission may, in case of disturbance, expel any troublemaker. He may seek help from the forces of law and order.

Article 17. - Before opening the ballot box for the vote counting exercise, the chairperson of the local polling commission must place a table, in the middle of the hall, on which the appointed scrutineers shall pour out all the ballot papers contained in the ballot box, for counting.

Article 18. - (1) The following shall not be taken into account in the vote count and must be considered as null and void:

- ballot papers other than those printed officially;
- ballot papers with any form of mark or identifiable symbol or signature;
- ballot papers found in envelopes other than those put at the disposal of the electors;
- ballot papers found in envelopes bearing identifiable marks;
- ballot papers of the various political parties found in the same envelope;
- ballot papers found in the ballot box without an envelope;
- envelopes found in the ballot box without ballot papers.

(2) The ballot papers thus rejected and, where appropriate, the envelopes containing them must be attached to the report in which their number must be equally indicated.

Article 19. - (1) The results of the poll must be recorded immediately in the report. This report must be drawn up in as many copies as there are members, plus 2 (two) other copies. Each copy shall be signed by the Chairperson and members of the Local Polling Commission.

(2) One (1) copy of the report must be handed to each of the members of the Local polling Commission present who had signed it.

(3) The result of the poll thus obtained in the polling station must be announced on the spot by the polling commission chairperson.

Article 20. - (1) At the end of the vote counting exercise, the chairperson of the local polling commission must attach the following documents to the report for onward transmission to the Regional Supervisory Commission:

- null and void ballot papers;
- ballot papers and envelopes that were subject to controversy;
- counting sheets signed by each of the scrutineers;
- any other relevant document relating to the conduct of the poll.

(2) He/she must put a copy of the report and the attached documents listed in Paragraph (1) above in an envelope and hand it to the competent Divisional Branch Head of Elections Cameroon, for onward transmission, in the shortest possible time, to the regional supervisory commission.

(3) The chairperson of the local polling commission must also forward a copy of the report to the competent Divisional Branch Head of Elections Cameroon for filing.

CHAPTER V

MISCELLANEOUS AND FINAL PROVISIONS

Article 21. - The local polling commission must express its view about any difficulty encountered in the organisation, conduct and counting of votes.

In case the commission's decision is challenged, either by a member, or by an attentive elector, or by a candidate, or by a representative of a political party, such challenge must be mentioned in the commission's report behind the decision entered in the report.

Article 22. - Any disturbance of public order and measures taken to check them, as well as any other relevant comment, received or made by the commission on the conduct of the poll must be mentioned in the local polling commission's report.

Article 23. - The chairperson of the local polling commission must, at the end of the above-mentioned exercises, gather the remaining material and documents used in the conduct of the poll and hand them over to the competent Divisional Branch Head of Elections Cameroon for safekeeping.

Article 24. - This decision shall be registered and published wherever necessary. /-

Yaounde, on 17 FEB 2023



DR ESSOUSSE Eri,

Director General of Elections

Copied to

- Constitutional Council;
- Chairperson/ELECAM
- MINAT;
- ELECAM branches;
- The Media (Wide broadcast)
- Public notice
- Chrono/Archives.

ANNEX 10**SAMPLE DECISIONS DETRMINING THE LIST OF POLLING STATIONS IN A GIVEN REGION
AND DISTRIBUTION OF ELECTORS WITHIN THEM**

N°	REFERENCE	REGION
1	DECISION NO 000033/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	ADAMAWA
2	DECISION NO 000034/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	CENTRE
3	DECISION NO 000035/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	EAST
4	DECISION NO 000036/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	FAR NORTH
5	DECISION NO 000037/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	LITTORAL
6	DECISION NO 000038/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	NORTH
7	DECISION NO 000039/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	NORTH-WEST
8	DECISION NO 000040/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	WEST
9	DECISION NO 000041/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	SOUTH
10	DECISION NO 000042/D/ELECAM/DGE OF 24 FEBRUARY 2023	SOUTH-WEST

ANNEX 11**REGIONAL DISTRIBUTION OF POLITICAL PARTIES RUNNING FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023
ELECTION OF SENATORS**

N°	Région	PARTIS POLITIQUES													Total
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	
		UNDP	RDPC	UPC	SDF	JDC	FDC	ANDP	MDR	PCRN	FSNC	UMS	UDC	UCDI	
1	Adamaoua														4
2	Centre														5
3	Est														2
4	Extrême-Nord														4
5	Littoral														3
6	Nord														3
7	Nord-Ouest														3
8	Ouest														4
9	Sud														1
10	Sud-Ouest														1
TOTAL		4	10	5	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	30

ANNEX 12**PRE-ELECTION PETITIONS RELATED TO LIST OF CANDIDATES FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023
ELECTION OF SENATORS**

No .	Petitioner	Grounds for petition	ELECAM's response
1	DIBAMOU André Marie and Jeunesse Démocratique du Cameroun (JDC) vs. ELECAM and Others	1. That the Electoral Board wrongfully accepted the lists of candidates of the following political parties in the Centre Region: FDC, CPDM, UCDI and UPC 2. That the CPDM and FDC had filed their lists of candidates after the stipulated deadline.	1. The Electoral Board did not accept the lists of candidates of the UCDI and the UPC in the Centre Region. 2. The FDC and the CPDM had filed their respective nomination papers within the legal deadline of 28 January 2023.
2	DIBAMOU André Marie and Jeunesse Démocratique du Cameroun (JDC) Vs. ELECAM	That the reasons given by the Electoral Board for rejecting the list of candidates of the JDC are unfounded, namely: <i>"nomination papers for all the candidates not signed and not legalised; - Lack of proof of payment of deposit for all candidates; - Lack of non-conviction (Criminal Record Form No 3) for all the candidates"</i>	1. Mr DIBAMOU André Marie explicitly recognises that he had filed a joint nomination paper for all the 14 candidates (substantive and alternate) of the JDC . 2. Violation of Section 164 of the Electoral Code
3	(CPDM) Vs. Elections Cameroon (ELECAM)	- That the Electoral Board wrongfully accepted the list of NUDP candidates in the Adamawa Region on the grounds that the candidate MAPOH Cécile had dual nationality	However, the petitioners did not produce the alleged multiple national identity cards for which the accused candidate is or was holder
4	DAISSALA WAIGRAO Vs. ELECAM and MDR	That the Electoral Board accepted the MDR's list of candidates in the Far North Region even though the said list was filed by a person not duly authorised and in violation of the party's instruction not to file nomination papers on behalf of the MDR, but rather to support the CPDM	- That on 3/12/22 a convention was organised by MDR militants with a view to elect interim leaders of this political party. - The resolutions of the above convention have never been appealed before the courts
5	Hon. DAGUE Aïcha Blanche Jacqueline (Member of the National Assembly) and Mr MATOUROUA TCHAKREO (Mayor of TOULOU Council) Vs. ELECAM and MDR	That the Electoral Board wrongfully accepted the list of candidates of the MDR in the Far North Region, the said list having been submitted, according to the petitioner, by a person not having the capacity to do so	With proof of the MDR party convention on 3 December 2022, Mr DJORWE Paulin has the right to submit MDR's list of candidates
6	Mrs ADJI Marie Paule (MDR)	That the Electoral board wrongfully accepted the list of CPDM candidates in the Adamawa Region, on the grounds that the file of Mrs SAIDATOU	The complaint raised by the petitioner cannot stand insofar as Mrs ADJI Marie Paule recognises that Mrs SAIDATOU DJALLA is

No .	Petitioner	Grounds for petition	ELECAM's response
	Vs. ELECAM	DJALLA KALKABA, candidate of the said list, does not conform to the law because it contains a fake birth certificate and a false declaration	actually holder of a birth certificate
7	AHMADOU Ahidjo Vs. ELECAM and CPDM	That the Electoral Board changed the order of presentation of candidates on the CPDM list of the West Region by removing him from the position of head of the list for that of alternate candidate No 6. The petitioner also mentions disregard of the sociological component by the CPDM list in the West Region, because according to him, his Mbororo community was not taken into account	ELECAM has no authority to interfere in the compilation of lists of candidates, it is the sole prerogative of political parties. Since Mr AHMADOU Ahidjo is himself a Mbororo, his community has been taken into account
8	PEKOUA Michel Elador and UPC Vs. ELECAM	That the Electoral Board wrongfully rejected the lists of UPC candidates of the West Region. In his defence, he mentions the unfounded nature of the grounds for rejection contained in the notification	The attitude that ELECAM should adopt had been decided by the Constitutional Council during the last legislative and municipal elections and whose decisions are not subject to any appeal
9	MOHAMADOU Awal and UPC Vs. ELECAM	That the reasons given by the Electoral Board for rejecting the list of candidates of the UPC in the Adamawa Region are unfounded	The following documents were absent in the files of all the candidates: - residence certificates; - proof of payment of deposit; - attestation of registration on an electoral register
10	Mr Médard Lambert NKOLO and UPC Vs. ELECAM and CPDM	That the Electoral Board wrongfully accepted the list of CPDM candidates in the North West Region, arguing that Mrs FONTAMA Hilda whose name appears on the said list, does not reside in Boyo Division	- All the constituent documents of the nomination papers were provided by the concerned party; - The constituency for the election of Senators is the Region. Therefore, any candidate having a residence in the Region may stand for election there
11	UPC Vs. ELECAM	That the Electoral Board wrongfully rejected the list of UPC candidates for the Littoral Region, because the reasons for doing so are unfounded	- According to the law of the Constitutional Council on the matter, " <i>If a political party submits more than one list of candidates in the same constituency, all of them shall be rejected</i> ". - The files accompanying the nomination papers are incomplete because the following documents are absent: 1- non-payment of a deposit; 2- insufficient nomination papers; 3- lack of nomination papers for some candidates
			ELECAM has no authority to

No .	Petitioner	Grounds for petition	ELECAM's response
12	SDF Vs. ELECAM and CPDM	That the Electoral Board wrongfully accepted the list of CPDM candidates for the North-West Region. The sociological component was not respected	interfere in the compilation of lists, as this is a matter for political parties. However, the CPDM list in the North West Region did take into account all the sociological components of the Region
13	UPC Vs. ELECAM	That the Electoral Board wrongfully rejected the list of UPC candidates for the Littoral Region, because the reasons for doing so are unfounded	- According to the law of the Constitutional Council on the matter, " <i>If a political party submits more than one list of candidates in the same constituency, all of them shall be rejected</i> ". - The files contained in the nomination papers are incomplete, because of lack of the following documents: 1- non-payment of a deposit; 2- insufficient nomination papers; 3- lack of nomination papers for some candidates

ANNEX 13**ROLL OF THE PUBLIC HEARING HELD ON TUESDAY, 21 MARCH 2023 ON POST-ELECTION PETITIONS FOR THE 12 MARCH 2023 ELECTION OF SENATORS**

N°	NOMS DES PARTIES	OBJET DES REQUETES	CONSEILLER RAPPORTEUR
01	Sieur RAMANI YIE C/ - PRESIDENT DE LA REPUBLIQUE - PRESIDENT DU SENAT - PRESIDENT DE L'ASSEMBLEE NATIONALE	Avis du Conseil Constitutionnel sur le sens réel de l'article 277 du Code Electoral instituant « une Commission de contrôle » sur l'utilisation des fonds publics alloués aux candidats et partis politiques pour le financement de leur campagne électorale et référendaire	Monsieur BAH OUMAROU SANDA
02	Sieur MAFOGHO INUSA PETIANGMA (SDF) C/ - ELECAM - MINAT - RDPC	Petition for cancelation of the Senatorial Elections for the North West Region on the grounds of fraud, intimidation and lack of free fair and transparency.	Madame Florence Rita ARREY
03	Sieur Denis Emilien ATANGANA (FDC) C/ - ELECAM - MINAT - RDPC	Requête en annulation partielle de l'élection sénatoriale dans le bureau de vote du Lycée Classique de Nanga Eboko B	Monsieur Charles Etienne LEKENE DONFACK
04	Sieur Denis Emilien ATANGANA (FDC) C/ - ELECAM - MINAT - RDPC	Requête en annulation totale des opérations électorales des sénatoriales dans la Région du Centre	Monsieur Charles Etienne LEKENE DONFACK
05	Sieur EKANI OTTOU Gofroy Serge (FDC) C/ - ELECAM - MINAT - RDPC	Requête en annulation partielle de l'élection sénatoriale dans certains bureaux de vote dans la Région du Centre	Monsieur Charles Etienne LEKENE DONFACK
06	- Dame FENGED Rose (UNDP) - Union Nationale pour la Démocratie et le Progrès C/ - ELECAM - MINAT - RDPC	Requête en annulation des opérations électorales dans la circonscription de l'Extrême-Nord à l'occasion de de l'élection des Sénateurs du 12 mars 2023	Monsieur Jean-Baptiste BASKOUDA

YAOUNDE, LE.....



